



THE ULTIMATE

UPWORK GUIDE

BY FARAZ AHMED

www.farazthewebguy.com

THE ULTIMATE UPWORK GUIDE 1.51

*CONTAINING MY 10 YEARS OF KNOWLEDGE ON
UPWORK*

FARAZ AHMED AKA FARAZ THE WEB GUY

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Upwork Free Video Course (Urdu/Hindi):

<https://www.youtube.com/playlist?list=PLSVSIhot0UKFWqXTxNaLWCOqZcHegIFg->

Check out my website for my AI Proposal Writer:

<https://farazthewebguy.com/>

WHAT IS THIS GUIDE ABOUT?

This guide contains all my content related to Upwork that I have been posting since 2021. I started posting this content when I saw people struggling to make their career in freelancing.

They were trying out tips and tricks they learned from different videos and websites, but still, they continued to struggle, which made me wonder why. Upon observing closely, I found that no one was actually providing real help to those people. Most of the information was outdated, generic, and simply didn't work, and those who knew the secrets to freelancing were afraid to spill all the secrets. I found that out when I got my first comments on my first-ever post, which absolutely shocked me.

But there was also some good information available, but it was just that: information. It told what to write in the proposals, but it lacked examples of the jobs and proposals that helped win those jobs, which I believe would have given a lot of belief to the struggling freelancers, and this guide does just that.

This guide contains all the jobs and the proposals I wrote that helped me win those jobs, and the thought process behind writing those proposals. This guide also has many other tips and tricks, like what type of clients to target. Everything I know about Upwork is in this guide, and I will continue to update it as I learn new things myself, and I am hopeful that you will find this guide helpful.

The guide is not limited to Upwork, though. The knowledge you will gain from this guide can be applied to any

freelancing platform. I mention Upwork specifically because this is the platform I have worked on for the last 10 years.

NOTE: Most of my proposals you will see below are old proposals from when Upwork still allowed communication outside the platform before a contract.

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One Last Thing...

TIP 1: HOW TO FIND LONG-TERM CLIENTS ON UPWORK PART 1

A typical Freelancer Routine:

1. Bid on a project.
2. Get the project.
3. Deliver the project.
4. Go back to #1.

If you are bidding on jobs day after day, week after week, and month after month, then you are doing it wrong. You will tire yourself out eventually by becoming part of the rat race.

What you should be looking for are a few long-term, regular clients who give you regular work, so you never have to bid again.

There are three ways to do this. I am explaining my favorite way first, which is what I did when I started freelancing:

1. Find small projects which you can do in an hour or two.
2. Look at the client profile. Make sure it's the client with no previous projects on Upwork.
3. Write a stunning proposal and offer some value to the client to prove to him that you are the right person for the job. Example below.
4. Deliver the project with high-quality work.

Most people look at the client's profile, and if the client has no feedback or payment history, they don't bid on the project. I did the exact opposite because their job posts would have less competition or proposals, and there would be a high chance for me to land the job. And I knew that if I

provided quality work, then they would not go to any other freelancer in the future if they had any new task.

That's how I turned a \$6 client into a \$60k client, and it's still going. I am posting that job post and the proposal below.

Job Description

Ajax has stopped working on <link>. Looking for someone to fix.

My Proposal

Hi,

I looked at the website, and it seems that some scripts are conflicting with each other. It should be fixed in an hour or two (\$6-\$12). I've been working on PHP and WordPress since last 5+ years. I am also a Zend Certified PHP Professional (the top php certification available in the market).

I am available via email/skype/phone. Let me know if you want to proceed further.

Best Regards,
Faraz

Thought Process behind the Proposal

I looked at the website and found multiple jQuery files loading.

Post Proposal

The client immediately awarded me the job after the proposal and asked me to fix another issue, then another issue, and then another issue. Forward to nine years, and it is still going.

The above wasn't a fluke. I repeated the same for another project, and that turned out to be a \$100k client. 75% of the clients are still working with me since the last nine years.

TIP 2: HOW TO FIND LONG-TERM CLIENTS ON UPWORK PART 2

Below is the second way where we will be working with the old clients:

1. Search for a project that you can do. Big, small, doesn't matter.
2. The client needs to have a previous job history with good feedback.
3. If the project is about building or doing something from scratch (e.g., eCommerce website, SEO on the new website, etc.), then this client can potentially become your long-term client. That's because the completed website will always need updates in the future, so you can pitch in your maintenance plan after finishing the website. Similarly, if you do a good SEO and show results on the new website, the client will most likely stick with you.

However, if it's a project that just needs updates/fixes on an existing project, then you need to look at the following factors:

1. Look at the client's previous job history and find projects similar to the project you are applying to. For example, if you are applying to a WordPress project, then you will look for all the WordPress projects the client has posted in the past.
2. If you found similar projects in the client's history, then look at the name of the freelancers who have done those projects.
3. If all the freelancers are different, and they all have good feedback, then this is probably not the client for you.

Why?

There is a category of clients who just want to get their work done at the lowest cost possible and don't care who does it. Think about it: Why do they post a new job related to a niche if they have already worked with a freelancer previously in that same niche? Why don't they hire the same freelancer?

Here is my experience with one of those clients. It was a website hosted on a development URL, and the client wanted some fixes/changes done to it.

So, I got the job, finished it, and she sent a few more tasks. I did those tasks, too. Then she closed the job and left great feedback. I thought I got another long-term client.

Then something strange happened. As it was the development website, I thought I would get another task from her to make it live.

After a few days, I was just browsing new jobs and found a job posted by her. Do you know what the job was about? It was about making the website live. That baffled me. Why would someone do that? Why couldn't she ask me to make it live? Maybe she didn't like something about my work? I was hardly a month old freelancer and started doubting myself.

I was curious and wanted to understand the reason. I looked at her past jobs and found that she had used multiple developers to do her WordPress projects, and all of those freelancers had received great reviews.

That's when I decided that I would avoid such clients because my vision was clear: I wanted to work with clients who believed in long-term relationships.

PS. A few days later, she returned and told me that the freelancer she had hired to make the website live messed it

up, and she wanted me to do it. I felt triumphant, but I excused myself. She might have stuck with me after that, but looking at her history, I didn't want to take chances. You can call me naive, but I knew what type of clients I wanted to focus on.

There are always exceptions, and your experience may differ. But it's doubtful that they would stick with you if we look at the history of such clients. But if you are just starting out, then it's totally fine to work on any project you can get your hands on for the experience.

Remember: You just need 2-3 good, regular clients to make your freelancing journey less stressful. And as you start getting stable and predictable income, you can hire more people to delegate your work to and build your business further.

TIP 3: HOW TO FIND LONG-TERM CLIENTS ON UPWORK PART 3

The third way is the easiest, quickest, and most straightforward.

Just go to the job search page, and enter the name of your niche followed by the word “long term”. E.x. “seo long term”, “wordpress long term”, “content writing long term”, etc., and you will see the jobs from the clients who are looking for a long-term working relationship.

Then, it will be your proposal writing skills that will help you win those jobs.

The more command you have over your skill, the better proposals you will be able to write because you would have faced different problems and found different solutions working on your skill, which would help you immediately come up with a solution after reading the posted job. To gain experience in your skill, you can offer your services for free in the freelancing groups.

TIP 4: WORDS TO AVOID IN YOUR FREELANCE PROFILES & PROPOSALS PART 1

Word # 1: “We”

Serious / long-term clients want to work with individuals. The word “We” gives the impression that you won’t be the one to do the work and will outsource it to someone else.

Serious / long-term clients know that there are usually severe communication issues when that happens, resulting in delayed projects because the developer stops responding to the middleman, resulting in the middleman either not responding to the client or giving silly excuses. This happened to me twice, so now I immediately move on to the next proposal if I see the word “we” in any profile or proposal.

Tip: Use “I” not “we” for a better response rate, even if you outsource the job.

TIP 5: WORDS TO AVOID IN YOUR FREELANCE PROFILES & PROPOSALS PART 2

The second word I want to talk about is “Sir.” When we use “Sir” in our proposals, like “Hi Sir,” we show two things:

1. The lack of confidence in ourselves.
2. The lack of professionalism.

The word “Sir” turns off some clients, including me, because we think that if you don’t have confidence in yourself, then why should we have confidence in you for delivering our project?

It may look like a trivial matter, but if you start calling the clients by their names, like “Hi John,” “John,” or even a simple “Hi,” if you don’t know the name of the client, you will appear professional and increase the range of the clients interested in availing your service.

TIP 6: HOW TO INCREASE THE RESPONSE RATE FOR YOUR PROPOSALS ON UPWORK

The first 230 characters of your proposals are essential because that's the first part the client sees when you submit a proposal. Use these characters for two things:

1. Use a term/keyword, which is NOT present in the project description, related to the project to talk about the project.
2. Ask a question related to the project.

Being also a client on Upwork, I have found myself opening the proposals with the above 2 points first.

BONUS TIP 1: WRITING WINNING UPWORK PROPOSALS IN 2022

The method still works.

I have always focused on bidding on the jobs by clients that had the potential of becoming long-term clients because I didn't want to be a part of the rate race. I haven't looked at the Upwork jobs page since 2015. The last time I bid on and won a project was in 2017, and that was also the project by invitation. Most of my clients have been working with me since 2013.

Last week, I came across a job that looked similar to my first job on Upwork. Just for fun and out of curiosity, I applied to the job to check whether the method I used to nail every single job still worked. Below is the job description and the proposal I sent.

Job Description

Hello. My website is using wordpress, and I've been having issues with Error 404. It works only with plain permalinks, but I need it to work with permalinks using postname so I can better setup my SEO.

I need someone who is proficient with wordpress and who had this issue before and resolved it successfully. As mentioned above, the website is currently working using plain permalinks, and I need help with making it work with postname.

Thank you for replying to my job request.

My Proposal

<Client Name>, Most likely the issue is with the mod_rewrite apache module. I will be happy to fix it for you. Shouldn't take more than an hour to resolve it.

The Result

I was awarded the job after 24 hours and fixed the issue in 30 minutes. The client said that he would keep the job open and may send more work in the future, so it could possibly become another long-term client for me.

Things to Notice

Did you notice what I did in my short proposal? I simply told him a possible cause of the issue to give him the impression that I was a skillful and experienced developer. I also told him the time it would take for me to solve the issue, so he knew the cost of the solution upfront, helping him make a quick decision.

You would have also noticed that I didn't mention anything about myself. No experience, no qualifications, not even my name.

If you have heard of the Pareto Principle / 80-20 rule, it says to identify inputs that are potentially the most productive and make them the priority, and that's what I did in my proposal above. In other words: Always focus on the project and not on yourself in your proposals. Clients really don't care about your experience or portfolio. They are only interested in what you can do for them.

BONUS TIP 2: WHEN IS THE RIGHT TIME TO START FREELANCING?

If you ask me, I will say that you should start freelancing after spending 2-3 years honing your skills. I would recommend spending a couple of years working in a company, which will help you learn skills at a quicker rate. It will also help you improve your communication and learn different aspects of your business because Freelancing is also like a business. As a freelancer, you are the salesperson, project manager, executor, accountant, etc.

The reason I got instant success as a freelancer (You can read my story here: <https://farazthewebguy.com/overcoming-fear-of-failure/>) was that I had the five-year job experience behind me before I started the freelancing journey.

During my years in the job, I moved around in all the departments (even in the accounts department) because I was a newbie who was highly energetic and wanted to learn about everything.

My last year was in the sales department as a Business Analyst, which helped me learn about the different freelancing platforms and how to bid on them.

So to summarize: Find a job or internship, take on all the challenging projects, and make friends with people in all the departments, so you can learn about the entire business, which will help you become self-employed in the future if that's what you desire.

IMPORTANCE OF PROPOSALS

As freelancers, we all love when clients write detailed job descriptions with clear instructions of what they want us to do. Knowledgeable clients are the ones everyone wants to work with because they exactly know what they need and won't give you hell in the middle of the project by continuously changing the requirements.

Similarly, the clients love and pay more attention when the developers write to-the-point proposals. If you are bidding day after day and not winning jobs, but someone else is, then that someone got to be doing something you are not, and it all comes down to one thing: your proposal.

You can have a great profile in the world, you can have a great portfolio in the world, but the first thing the client is going to look at when you bid on their jobs is your proposal. The proposal is your first impression, and you need to utilize that space to sell to the client why you are a better fit for the job.

It's easy. Let's do a visualization exercise: Think of yourself as a client. You go to a freelance marketplace, post a project, and start receiving all the bids on your project by freelancers. What are you going to see first? Their proposals or their profiles? Their proposals.

Now, reverse the roles. As a freelancer, what would you write in your proposal? Below are the questions you should take into account when writing your proposals.

DO I HAVE THE SPECIFIC SKILLS FOR THE JOB?

Again, think from the client's point of view: You have posted a job, and you want to hire someone who completely understands what you want to get done. Would you be impressed with someone who shows their understanding, skills required and outlines the steps to accomplish the project in their proposal? Or would you be impressed with someone with the most impressive profile you have ever seen with multiple 5-star feedbacks, but who has sent a generic proposal boasting about simply how good they are?

In short: The client doesn't care who you are. He only wants to know whether you can do his job or not, so always get straight to the point when writing your proposal because they have other bids to read, too.

For example: If you are bidding on a WordPress project, you can mention the programming language you know, which is PHP, mention any plugins you have written, and the number of WordPress sites you have developed. This way, the client will immediately know when they read your proposal that you are not a copy-paster and have read the job description. That can make them develop an interest in you.

DO I UNDERSTAND THE PROJECT AND KNOW HOW TO FINISH IT?

What any client is interested in is that the freelancer understands his project and can provide the solution within his budget. The below is what I do:

If I see that the client is a technical person and has used technical terms in his job description, I write the project description in my own words to show that I understand the project. I also use the same technical language he used in his

job description and try to go as deep as possible. That can impress the client because you speak the same language as them making the communication process go smoothly.

If I see the client is not a technical person, then I still write the project description in my own words to show that I understand the project, but I try to explain it in simple language, aka layman's terms.

The point is to have clear communication using the same language they used, so they are comfortable talking to you.

HOW LONG WILL IT TAKE AND HOW MUCH WILL IT COST?

You cannot simply tell the client that it will take X hours of work and Y costs to complete the project. To show the client that you can correctly handle his project, break the project into smaller milestones or modules, and then assign the number of hours and cost to each module. Go as deep as possible, like what tools you will use, whether they will need to purchase anything (theme/plugins), and what hosting/server will be required. That will establish your credibility in the client's eyes.

The easiest way to come up with estimates is to look at the projects you have done in the past.

If you have already done the same project in the past, then you will know what estimates you need to give to the client.

If you have done something similar, then you can use that as a reference to create estimates for the new project.

If you have done nothing similar in the past, you can research any existing code, classes, or solution and give your best estimate. If you know that you can do something, but you are not sure of the exact time, then you can add some extra hours in your estimate just in case.

Coming up with reasonable estimates can be a frustrating experience, but your estimates will only improve with time and experience.

HAVE I COMPLETED A SIMILAR PROJECT SUCCESSFULLY?

You don't need to give the complete solution to the problem in your proposal, but there should be enough hints to make the client feel that you are the right person for the job.

Example: The client wants something fixed on an existing website, which could be a layout issue or a PHP error. I visit the website, look at the error message or the layout issue, and research the solution. If it's a general issue, I immediately find the fix, but I don't give it to the client. I only tell them what file/plugin has the error. This way, the client knows that I know my game.

If it's a brand new project, then I research all the information to complete the project. Then I add that information to my proposal. This way, the client will appreciate that I spent time and did my research.

If I have done a project in the past that matches the client's project requirements, then I add the link to it in my proposal.

Yes, researching takes time, and you may lose the project before the client sees your proposal. But one thing is for sure

that your proposal will stand out from the crowd if the job is still open, and you will have a better chance to land the job.

If you apply for a job without research but couldn't complete it after the client awards you the job, it can negatively affect your profile. So, I will advise you not to apply for a job without any research if you are unsure how to do it.

IS THERE A BETTER WAY TO ACCOMPLISH THE JOB?

The clients usually don't know what tools will be better to accomplish the job. That's why they come to us, so if you feel what the client is proposing to use is not an ideal solution and that the project can be done in a lesser amount of time and cost using another tool, then don't be afraid to tell the client your solution. The client will appreciate your advice and honesty and trust you more. Don't be someone who follows instructions without thinking about them. Be proactive.

To summarize: You need to write the proposal about the project, not yourself. You can add your bio and your portfolio links at the end of the proposal, not before, as most freelancers do. Use the beginning of the bid to talk about the project and grab the attention of the client.

Tell the client that you have the right skills and experience to accomplish the job, and give them the plan and the cost to complete the project. If you give the impression to the client that you have their best interests at heart by giving them good advice, the project will most likely be yours.

Thanks for reading until now. In the next chapter, you will find real jobs and the proposals that helped me win the jobs.

JOB 1: HELP NEEDED WITH 404 ERROR

JOB DESCRIPTION

Need help with my site. There is a bug I am not able to find.

MY PROPOSAL

Hello,

Could I have the link to your website, which shows the error?
Did you modify anything in the code before you got the error?

I have been working on PHP for 5+ years. I am also a Zend Certified PHP Developer (the official certification for PHP), and I am sure I can fix the error.

I am available via Email, Skype, or Phone to discuss the issue further. Let me know if you want to proceed further.

Best Regards,

Faraz

THOUGHT PROCESS BEHIND THE PROPOSAL

The job description didn't have enough information. However, as a web developer, I knew that the "404 error" comes up if a location/file is missing or if the "htaccess" file has an issue; that's why I requested the client to send the link to the website for me to check the problem.

POST PROPOSAL

The client asked me to contact them via Skype, and we discussed the task on Skype and resolved the issue. The “mod_rewrite” Apache module was disabled on the server.

The client gave me more work after that.

JOB 2: WORDPRESS EXPERT NEEDED

JOB DESCRIPTION

After the WordPress update, this error came up: .Warning: Missing argument <number> for wpdb::prepare(), called in <plugin location> on line <number> and defined in <location> on line <number> Shouldn't be a difficult fix, and shouldn't take more than an hour.

MY PROPOSAL

Hello,

I read the job description, and I know what is causing the error. A code in "nextgen-gallery'plugin" needs to be updated to be compatible with the new WordPress update.

I am a Zend Certified PHP Developer (the official certification for PHP), and I have been working on PHP/WordPress for the last 5+ years. I am available via Email, Skype, or Phone to discuss the issue further. Let me know if you want to proceed further.

Best Regards,

Faraz

What questions do you have about the project?

Nothing. It's pretty straight forward.

Have you taken any oDesk tests and done well on them that you think are relevant to this job?

PHP and WordPress.

THOUGHT PROCESS BEHIND THE PROPOSAL

All I had to do was Google the error message, and I got the solution in the first link because it was a common issue.

POST PROPOSAL

The client immediately awarded me the job after the proposal, and I resolved the issue.

JOB 3: <NAME> CLINIC

JOB DESCRIPTION

Easy job, just cut and paste new data to existing website - as in adding new text pages to replace present ones on live site via FTP.

Also a banner word change. Cart does not need to be changed but order page does.

Dreamweaver used.

website <link> - LOOK before you apply please.

Please don't apply if you cant do this work effortlessly, I have wasted a week already with pretenders.

Thanks.

MY PROPOSAL

Hello,

Sounds like a super easy job by reading the description of the project. I see that the site is created in OsCommerce (PHP), and I know my way around this shopping cart. I am also a Zend PHP Certified Professional (the top php certification available in the market).

I can start on this job asap. I am available via email / skype / phone to discuss this project further and answer any questions you may have. Please let me know if you want to proceed further.

Best Regards,

Faraz

What past project or job have you had that is most like this one and why?

<link> <- This website is also created in OsCommerce and I did the similar thing (copy / paste content) on this website.

What challenging part of this job are you most experienced in?

I don't think there is any challenging part on this project to be honest.

Do you have suggestions to make this project run successfully?

I will take backup of all the pages before I change the content of the pages, so in case if some screw up happens, or if the client asks to revert back some pages for any reason, I have the old copy of the pages ready.

THOUGHT PROCESS BEHIND THE PROPOSAL

It sounded like a data entry job, and I had worked on OsCommerce a lot, so it sounded like a super easy job.

POST PROPOSAL

The client immediately awarded me the job after the proposal. The client also stuck with me for years and gave me more work.

JOB 4: OSCOMMERCE EXPERT NEEDED

JOB DESCRIPTION

I have a website that was programmed in oscommerce. We are having issues that customers who try to buy using Internet Explorer 10 are having issues checking out or timing out.

I need immediate help the store address is <link>

Please look at the website before you respond or I WILL NOT REPLY back to your request.

I need to know what is wrong and list to me the issues.

MY PROPOSAL

Hi,

I signed up at <link>and tried a test order using IE 10. I got to the payment page without any issues (I also tried a wrong credit card info and got the error response from the payment gateway). Could you tell me what error messages your clients are getting and on what page(s) if possible?

As for me: I've been working on PHP and eCommerce sites since last 5+ years. I am also a Zend Certified PHP Professional (the top php certification available in the market).

I am available via email/skype/phone to discuss this job further. Let me know if you want to proceed further.

Best Regards,

Faraz

1. How many oscommerce websites have you worked on

10+. The latest I worked on yesterday from oDesk: <link>

This is my best work: <link>

Which of the required job skills do you feel you are strongest at?

All of them to be honest.

THOUGHT PROCESS BEHIND THE PROPOSAL

I had worked on OsCommerce a lot, so I went to the problem website and tried to replicate the issue. However, I was unsuccessful. So, I asked the client to give more details.

POST PROPOSAL

We had back and forth communication, and the client awarded me the project after I figured out the problem. The client gave me more work after that, and they are still with me to this date.

JOB 5: 2 SIMPLE .PHP TASKS

JOB DESCRIPTION

I'm using Wordpress as a CMS and am in need of a plug-in add-on.

The plug-in being used is Event Organiser (<link>). I am trying to find a way to:

- 1) Reverse the order of posts so that most recent events are posted at the top of the archive page (in reverse chronological order) and
- 2) Include a 'previous' and 'next' button beneath each single post.

I have some base .php written by the developer of the plug-in, but it doesn't seem to be working as is (I think it has syntax errors).

Any/all help appreciated.

MY PROPOSAL

Hi,

Sounds like an extremely simple job, and should be completed within an hour. I've been working on PHP and WordPress since last 5+ years. I am also a Zend Certified PHP Professional (the top php certification available in the market).

I am ready to start immediately. Let me know if you want to proceed further.

Best Regards,

Faraz

THOUGHT PROCESS BEHIND THE PROPOSAL

I was a WordPress expert, so I knew that I could use WordPress filters to reverse the order of the posts and add the next/previous links in single.php.

POST PROPOSAL

The client immediately awarded me the job after the proposal. The client also gave me more work after that.

JOB 6: PHP PROGRAMMER FOR QUIZ. TWEAKS

JOB DESCRIPTION

Fixing up the php script at <link>

It's a simple job and shouldn't take a decent php developer very more then an hour or two.

- I've completed the programming and design for the actual quiz, you'll need to do two tasks:

- Email capture must work with GetResponse (API)

- User is given the option to select their gender and will be forwarded to the appropriate page depending on if they're male or female.

If you've actually read this description copy and past this code into your reply: HBD5HOQZ76B

Thanks!

MY PROPOSAL

Which part of this project do you think will take the most time?

HBD5HOQZ76B

Hi,

I've read the description of the project and visited the link, and yes it indeed sounds like a pretty simple job. I've already

got the API code for GetResponse, You just need to provide me with the API key and Campaign ID. I have one thing to confirm through: We are only sending the email address to GetResponse API, but not the answers?

As for me: I've been working on PHP since last 5+ years. I am also a Zend Certified PHP Professional (the top php certification available in the market).

I am available via email/skype/phone to discuss this job further. Let me know if you want to proceed further.

Best Regards,

Faraz

THOUGHT PROCESS BEHIND THE PROPOSAL

I had the GetResponse code from an older project I did, so I applied to the job knowing that I would be able to do it.

POST PROPOSAL

The client immediately awarded me the job after the proposal. The client also gave me more work after that.

JOB 7: <LINK>/CONTACT

JOB DESCRIPTION

Hi,

Sorry my last post was wrong.

I just need the "email" box changing on this page to match the others.

Thanks.

MY PROPOSAL

Hi,

It's a simple 15 minutes job. I've been working on PHP and WordPress since last 5+ years. I am also a Zend Certified PHP Professional (the top php certification available in the market).

I am available via email/skype/phone. Let me know if you want to proceed further.

Best Regards,

Faraz

Which of the required job skills do you feel you are strongest at?

PHP, WordPress

Do you have any questions about the job description?

It's straight forward.

THOUGHT PROCESS BEHIND THE PROPOSAL

It was a simple CSS fix, so I applied to the job knowing that I could do it.

POST PROPOSAL

The client contacted me on Skype, and after discussing a few things, they awarded me the job. They gave me another job after that.

JOB 8: MOBILE WP WEBSITE NEEDED WITH MEMBER FUNCTIONALITY

JOB DESCRIPTION

Mobile WP website with member functionality (alternatives are welcome)

Member login function.

Social media login (Facebook, Twitter and Google)

Forms integration

Responsive Site

Fast loading time

MY PROPOSAL

Hi <Name>,

Thank you for your invitation. Yes, WordPress will be best for this, as I have developed many websites in WordPress for the last 5+ years, and it is easy for the clients to update the website themselves.

For the membership functionality, we can use this plugin because it is easy to work on: <link>

Please review the following website I worked on: <link>This is a responsive website.

For the forms: Gravity Forms plugin is the best. There are also many free plugins available that we can use, but it

depends on what we are using the forms for, like whether they will be contact forms or forms that save user data in the database.

We can discuss the site speed after I get more details about the project. It will depend on the number of images, pages, users, loyalty program, etc. There are a lot of approaches we can use to achieve quick load times. Like caching, hosting scripts & images on content delivery networks like AWS, using a dedicated server, etc. But it will all depend on our case.

I am available to start immediately. I am also available via email/skype/phone to discuss this job further. My skype is <skype>. Let me know if you want to proceed further.

Best Regards,

Faraz

THOUGHT PROCESS BEHIND THE PROPOSAL

I was a WordPress expert, and the client had invited me, so I accepted the invite.

POST PROPOSAL

We talked on Skype, and the client awarded me the project after that. The client stuck with me for more projects and referred me to many other people.

JOB 9: WORDPRESS: AJAX BROKEN

JOB DESCRIPTION

Ajax has stopped working on <link>. Looking for someone to fix.

MY PROPOSAL

Hi,

I looked at the website, and it seems that some scripts are conflicting with each other. It should be fixed in an hour or two (\$6-\$12). I've been working on PHP and WordPress since last 5+ years. I am also a Zend Certified PHP Professional (the top php certification available in the market).

I am available via email/skype/phone. Let me know if you want to proceed further.

Best Regards,

Faraz

THOUGHT PROCESS BEHIND THE PROPOSAL

I looked at the website and found multiple jQuery files loading.

POST PROPOSAL

The client immediately awarded me the job after the proposal and gave me more work after that. They are still with me to this date.

JOB 10: HELP NEEDED ADDING MEMBERSHIP AND FORM AUTOFILL TO WORDPRESS SITE

JOB DESCRIPTION

Hello,

I have a nonprofit media website for animal rights, human rights and environmental issues. I am looking for a solution to enable people to sign up as members at multiple levels, including free and paid.

Very importantly, all forms on the website must be able to auto-fill for members when they are logged in. I currently have Ninja Forms set up, and the forms are rather complex so I would like to continue using them, just add the autofill feature.

If this is something you think you can help with, please let me know a cost estimate and we'll go from there. Thanks so much!

--<Name>

MY PROPOSAL

Hi <Name>,

Ninja Forms provide functions to auto-fill fields, so that can be done. I also know a very good WordPress membership plugin I am running on a few sites that will work without doing too many modifications. Before I can provide you with

a cost estimate, could you tell me how many forms are there on the site? Can I see the site url?

I am a Zend-Certified PHP Professional (top PHP certification in the market) and have been working on PHP/WordPress for the last 7+ years. Thanks for inviting me. You won't be disappointed.

Best Regards,

Faraz

THOUGHT PROCESS BEHIND THE PROPOSAL

I was a WordPress expert, and the client had invited me, so I accepted the invite.

POST PROPOSAL

We had back and forth communication to clear some points, and then the client awarded me the project and gave me more work after that. They are still with me to this date.

AVOID THE RAT RACE

If you are bidding on jobs day after day, week after week, and month and after month, then you are doing it wrong. You will tire yourself out eventually by becoming part of the rat race.

What you should be looking for are a few long-term, regular clients who give you regular work, so you never have to bid again.

When I started bidding, I tried to find smaller and cheap jobs with one or two tasks. I also looked for the clients who were new to Upwork with no history because their job posts would have less competition or proposals, and there would be a high chance for me to land the job. And I knew that if I provided quality work, then they would not go to any other freelancer in the future if they had any new task. That's how I turned a \$20 client into a \$100k client, and it's still going.

The clients that have a good history are usually looking for cheap work. They are not looking for a long-term prospect. Why do they post a new job related to a category if they have already worked with a freelancer previously in that same category? Why don't they hire the same developer?

So, go against the tide, keep trying, and all the pieces will fall into place with the experience. There is no shortcut to success.

WHAT TO DO IF YOUR UPWORK JSS TAKES A HIT?

Every client wants to hire the best, ideally someone with a 100% JSS. I know I would.

So, what to do when your JSS takes a hit and goes lower than 100%?

If it's still above 90%, then you may not feel the effects. However, if it goes below 90%, then it could mean trouble for you when bidding on bigger projects, especially with established clients.

The first thing you need to do is look at yourself in the mirror and ask, "**Mirror, Mirror on the wall, who's the fairest of them all?**"

Oops. No! You should ask yourself, "**Why did my JSS go down in the first place?**" This is a crucial question to ask yourself, and you need to ask it with a cool head. Not everything is the client's fault. Perhaps there was something in your work or communication that led the client to give you poor feedback.

Once you've recognized the issue that caused the client to give you poor feedback, it's essential not to repeat it.

But what to do with the poor JSS now? There are two ways that I usually suggest to people:

1. Think of yourself as a beginner now and go through my beginner's guide (check the link in my profile bio). The strategy is to focus on small projects by new clients posting their first project on Upwork because those clients usually don't pay much attention to the JSS or the top-rated badges.

They mostly look at the proposals, and if your proposal is good, you get the job. You can also get help from my AI Proposal writer. Again, the link is in my profile bio.

2. If you have any direct clients outside Upwork, ask one or two of them to work with you through Upwork. You can provide them with some sort of incentive to encourage them to work with you through Upwork. Upwork gives more weight to long-term clients and projects with higher earnings, so this strategy can help boost your score.

And there is another way, but I won't even go there because that's unethical and against my moral values. Please don't bring that up in our conversations either. The joy that you get after achieving results through your honest, hard work is beyond measure!

HOW TO FIND SMALL PROJECTS ON UPWORK?

If you're new to Upwork, I always recommend that beginners try smaller projects on Upwork first because they help you gain confidence and build a good work history.

But with so many job listings, finding these smaller projects can be tricky. That's where the “**Upwork Job Filter**” Google Chrome extension comes in. This tool allows you to see jobs with shorter descriptions, making it easier for you to quickly read through and decide which ones to apply for.

Remember, just because a job has a short description doesn't mean it's a small job. But a short description does mean you can read and understand the job's requirements more quickly, helping you decide faster if it's right for you.

Here is the link to the extension:

<https://farazthewebguy.com/upwork-job-filter-google-chrome-extension/>

I WRITE VERY GOOD PROPOSALS, BUT I AM NOT RECEIVING ANY RESPONSES ON UPWORK

It's a common query that I receive every day.

There are multiple reasons for not receiving any responses from clients despite writing excellent proposals, but let's discuss the common reason today:

When someone tells me the above, I always ask them to send me their profile link.

And you know what I see in the profile most of the time? A poor JSS or less than 100% JSS.

As a client myself, who has hired quite a few freelancers on Upwork, I always look for top-rated freelancers with 100% JSS and will never hire someone without the top-rated freelancer badge and less than 100% JSS. That's just how it is for me, and I am sure a typical client who frequently hires on Upwork also works this way.

So, if you are not top-rated or if your JSS is less than 100%, and you are not receiving responses despite writing good proposals, consider yourself a beginner and try my beginner's guide, where I recommend applying to new clients and smaller projects. You will have a better chance of landing projects that way.

And once you have achieved the top-rated status with 100% JSS, you can apply to bigger projects and existing clients.

UPWORK PROPOSAL WRITING FOR DIGITAL MARKETERS

Although I don't provide digital marketing services on Upwork, I know what to look for when hiring a professional in this field.

For digital marketers, it's essential to showcase past campaigns, especially those relevant to the client's industry. Include metrics that demonstrate success, such as increased website traffic, conversion rates, or sales growth, right at the beginning of their Upwork proposals.

For example: "Digital Marketer with a history of 150% website traffic growth for clients in your sector. Past campaigns led to a 45% conversion rate increase and a 30% sales boost. I provide detailed metrics to prove success. Let's replicate this for your brand!"

The idea is to be unique and attract the client's attention to your Upwork proposal within the first 230 characters. The primary goal is to make the client open your proposal. If you follow the advice above, they will undoubtedly be curious to see what you can offer.

Once they initiate a conversation, your communication skills and rates will decide the outcome.

Don't mention your name and years of experience at the beginning. No one's interested in you until they see what you can do for them. Such is life, eh?

UPWORK BOOSTED PROFILES

Just as there were Boosted proposals, Upwork has now introduced a new feature: Boosted profiles.

Upwork is a business, and its goal is to make money. Let them profit from those who are easily swayed. However, you shouldn't be overly concerned about this. Here's why:

Before the Proposal Boost Feature: There might have been times when someone else's proposal ranked above yours, but you still secured jobs, didn't you?

It's the same situation with this new feature. Before its introduction, someone's profile might have consistently ranked above yours, but you still received interview invitations, right?

When someone boosts their profile or proposal, it's labeled "Boosted" next to it. Now, ask yourself: When you search for something on Google, which links are you more inclined to click on? Sponsored ones or the organic ones? Various studies have indicated that organic results account for approximately 70% or more of the total clicks, with the remaining 30% or less going to paid results.

So relax.

AI PROPOSAL WRITER VERSION 3

When I write a proposal for an Upwork project, I start my proposal with either:

1. A question if the project requirements are not clear.
2. A hint of the solution if the project requirements are clear.

The V2 version of my AI Proposal Writer started the proposal with a question. However, as of today, V3 (which went live today) also attempts to include a hint of the solution at the start of the proposal whenever possible, making it the most comprehensive and final version. This gives the impression to the client that the freelancer understands the solution to their problem, increasing your chances of winning the project.

You may not notice much difference between V2 and V3, but the subtle change of including the solution can be a game-changer, especially for smaller projects that require bug fixing.

Please go ahead and test the new version. I am still making changes to it, so V2 remains the default version because it has been the most successful version so far.

Here is the link to my AI Proposal Writer:

<https://farazthewebguy.com/ai-proposal-writer/>

UPWORK BEGINNER'S GUIDE

A common question I am asked is: "**How can I get my first project on Upwork as a beginner? There's too much competition!**"

I'm posting my response here, so I can give the link to everyone who asks the same question in the future.

Below are the steps I used to hunt for projects when I was starting on Upwork, and I will use these steps again to hunt for clients in the future:

1. Bid between 5 p.m. - 11 p.m. CST. Reason: There's usually less competition. I won most of my jobs between 6 p.m. and 9 p.m.

2. Bid on new clients with unverified payment methods
Reason: Most people don't bid on projects from clients with no project history or unverified payment method, so the competition decreases further. Also, as an established client, I always prefer top-rated freelancers. That's why I suggest avoiding bidding on clients with a history when you're a beginner because they are highly unlikely to hire you. New clients mostly don't notice badges. They just want to get their work done, and the profile picture and the proposal are the two most important things for them. There's also another advantage to bidding on new clients, which is mentioned at the end.

3. Bid on small projects. These projects will help you build your reputation on the platform quickly, gain some positive reviews, and get some experience under your belt, allowing you to bid on medium-sized and large-sized projects.

4. The first 230 characters of your proposal are important. I use these characters to either: 1) Ask a question related to the project. 2) If I know the solution to the issue, I give a hint of the solution to the client, so they know I'm the right person for the job, along with the price and the time estimate, with a call to action to hire me now if they want me to fix the issue immediately. You can take the help of my AI Proposal writer to get an idea. **Note:** This tip was also endorsed by Upwork itself in one of their articles, as you can see in the attached picture.

5. After the client sends you the offer, ensure the two things below before accepting the offer:

a) Make sure you have all the project details, and you are 100% certain of what you need to do in the project. Don't accept the offer in excitement. Ensure you have all the details first.

b) Confirm that the client has verified their payment method by now. If not, ask them to do so. If they are a legitimate client, they will, and you can accept the offer. If not, they might make excuses. If they do the latter, reject the offer. You'll waste your Connects, but you'll save yourself from a scam.

c) It's important to heed the above steps for new clients because if the client turns out to be a scammer after you accept the offer, and even if you cancel the contract without working on it, the client can still give you private feedback (not public, though). And if they give poor private feedback, your profile will take a hit!

6. Once you accept the offer, overdeliver! If the client has asked you to do one thing, do two! The goal is to make the

client's first experience with their initial freelancer as positive as possible! Because if they're pleased with your work and have more work in the future, they'll always return to you!

If you follow the steps above, there's a high chance you'll come across some long-term clients who will provide regular work, allowing you to avoid the constant bidding war. All you need are a few long-term clients to generate a stable income in your freelancing career. That's how I've thrived for the last 10 years.

UPWORK PROFILE OPTIMIZATION

One of the most common requests I get is, "**Please review my Upwork profile and let me know how it can be improved.**"

And I have found myself giving the same response again and again. So, to save myself time, I decided to create a post (I will also create a video later) on this topic so I can give the link to everyone who requests the same from now on.

Okay, so now take a look at the image below.

Other than the profile picture, it's a very poorly optimized profile.

Let's break down the profile. Do note that I also hire on Upwork as a client, so the observations below are from the client's point of view:

Profile Picture: It needs to be a smiling photo with much of your face showing. It also needs to give a good vibe to the client and shouldn't be depressing to look at.

Profile Title: Be specific about what you do. Niche down and always use keywords related to your work. Do not have a generic title like the dude in the attached screenshot. What in the world does "PHP Developer" even mean? OK, I know you work on PHP, but exactly what kind of applications or websites do you develop with PHP? I, as a client, am looking to develop a website using the Laravel Framework. Can you do that? It doesn't show in your title.

Since I am more of a WordPress coder, the ideal title would have been: "WordPress Theme & Plugin Developer | PHP Developer."

Now, the client who is looking for a WordPress theme and plugin developer will immediately know, by reading just the title, what specific services the freelancer provides. If he needs the same service, he will click on your profile.

Profile Description: Let's say a client searches for a WordPress developer. The search listings only show the first couple of lines from the profile description. If you start your profile description with "I am this" and "I am that," the client won't care because it doesn't tell him what services you provide. It would have been ideal if the dude in the screenshot had started his profile description with the services he offers. This way, the client would have immediately known if the freelancer offered the same service he was looking for and clicked on his profile.

Specialized Profiles: Upwork has given the option to create two specialized profiles, and most people are using the options to include completely different niches, which gives an unprofessional look to your profile. If the client lands on your profile, hoping to get WordPress work done, and sees that you also do digital marketing and video editing, he might think you are not an expert in anything and are most likely going to outsource the work. I steer clear of such profiles. Always create specialized profiles within your original niche and use an agency to sell multiple services.

Example of specialized profiles for someone working on WordPress:

WordPress Security Auditor (Main)

WordPress Plugin Developer

WordPress Theme Developer

Alright, I have made enough fun of myself, but am I going to make the edits that I suggested to myself? Not at this time, because I am not actively looking for work. Also, since the very beginning, I have believed in proactively approaching clients by bidding on jobs instead of waiting for clients to come to me. If your proposal is convincing, the client is not going to care much about your profile. Even if your profile is optimized, shows up in search results, and you get invitations, you still have to write a good proposal to win the job. So, stop worrying about not getting views on your profile and catch the bull by its horns.



Faraz A.
Karachi, Pakistan

 100% Job Success  Top Rated Plus

Ready to work with Faraz A.?
[Sign up](#)
[Already have an account? Log in](#)

64
Total Jobs

14,654
Total Hours

Hours per week

PHP Developer ?? **\$35.00/hr**

I just don't love my website, I also help you in accomplishing your goals, which includes doing basic On-Page SEO on your website, to writing a review about your website on my blog to getting the word out by sharing the website with my contacts, and last, but not the least, by giving free advice on how we can do a certain thing better to reap greater rewards. I believe in building long term relationships, and it gives me a great satisfaction when you make money off the work I do for you.

I am a Zend Certified Engineer (top PHP certification available in the market), and I've been working on PHP since last 5 years. I worked on many different PHP applications, frameworks, payment gateways, and web services, like WordPress, Zen Cart, Magento, Open Cart, CodeIgniter, Paypal, Authorize.Net, First Data, Quickbooks, eBay, Newegg, Amazon FPS, etc. I've also worked on a lot of custom applications and some of them are making thousands of dollars online today.

HOW TO GET FREE UPWORK CONNECTS

A common question I am asked: **How to get free Upwork Connects**

~~1. When you first sign up for Upwork, you'll get 50 complimentary Connects within 48 hours.~~

1. When you join Upwork, you need to either purchase 100 Connects or subscribe to the Freelancer Plus plan if you want to submit proposals. Once you choose one, Upwork will give you a one-time bonus of 50 Connects to help get you started on Upwork

2. Earn a Rising Talent badge and you'll be rewarded with 30 free Connects.

3. Secure an interview with a seasoned Upwork client and you'll receive a variable number of free Connects. (Details on what qualifies as "seasoned" are not fully disclosed to prevent manipulation.)

4. Complete an Upwork Skill Certification and you'll receive a one-time Connects bonus.

5. Freelancer Basic active accounts may receive 10 free Connects each month.

6. Random free connects. No specific criteria.

WHY SOME CLIENTS DON'T HIRE ANYONE FOR THEIR JOBS

So, you found an interesting job and applied for it. You waited and waited, but you didn't receive any response from the client. Eventually, the job automatically closed after a month, and you noticed that nobody was hired for the job.

"Why?" you may wonder. You've also noticed this happening with a lot of other job postings. "Why don't clients hire anyone after posting the job?" you wonder again.

Let me share a story with you: Once upon a time, there was a client who wanted to hire someone for his project. He knew that there were many freelancing platforms like Upwork, Guru, Freelancer dot com, etc. He decided to post his job on all these platforms simultaneously.

He wasn't impressed with the proposals he received on Freelancer dot com, so he didn't hire anyone there.

Similarly, he didn't like the proposals on Guru dot com, so he didn't hire anyone from that platform either.

However, he was pleased with what he saw on Upwork and ended up hiring one of the freelancers there.

As a result, nobody was hired on Freelancer dot com or Guru dot com, leading freelancers on those platforms to label the job as "fake."

But was it really fake? If you say "yes," then I must apologize. That client was me.

If you believe that a client has the right to choose any freelancer he wants from any platform, then you now

understand one of the reasons why some clients don't hire anyone for their jobs.

NOT EVERY CLIENT IS GOING TO HIRE SOMEONE FOR EVERY JOB THEY POST

So, if you don't receive a response to your proposals, don't panic and immediately assume that your proposal or profile is the reason you didn't get a response.

First, review the job listings to which you've applied and see if the client has already hired someone. Check the video in the comments to find out where you can see the number of hires for each job.

If I applied to 10 jobs and only 2 of them resulted in hires, I wouldn't be too concerned. If the number is 3, I'd start to worry a little. If the number is 4 or more, that's when I'd really start to panic (AHHHHHHHHHHHHHHH!) and dig deep to figure out what went wrong. Here are some things I would consider:

1. Did I apply to a featured job, and I'm not a top-rated freelancer?
2. Was the client already interviewing a large number of freelancers?
3. Did my profile title, description, proposal, and skill set include keywords that matched the job description, thereby earning me the "best match" badge?

And finally:

4. Did I write a compelling proposal?

I would analyze all these factors, jot down notes, and aim to improve for next time.

WordPress

HTML

PHP

CSS

JavaScript

Web Development

Geolocation

Activity on this job

Proposals:  5 to 10

Last viewed by client:  6 days ago

Hires: 1

Interviewing: 5

Invites sent: 0

Unanswered invites: 0

WANT TO FIND CLIENTS WHO ARE LOOKING FOR LONG TERM PROSPECTS?

It's simple really. Just go to the job search page, and enter the name of your niche followed by the word "long term". E.x. "seo" "long term", "wordpress" "long term", "content writing" "long term", etc., and you will see the jobs from the clients who are looking for a long-term working relationship.

Then, it will be your proposal writing skills that will help you win responses from those clients (you can take help of my free AI proposal writing tool to do that).

The more command you have over your skill, the better proposals you will be able to write because you would have faced different problems and found different solutions working on your skill, which would help you immediately come up with a solution after reading the posted job. One way to gain experience in your skill is to offer your services for free in freelancing groups.

Search

Saved Jobs

"wordpress" "long term"



Save search

Advanced Search

666 jobs found

Sort: Newest

View:

I need a Web Designer



Hourly: \$10-\$20 - Expert - Est. Time: 1 to 3 months, Less than 30 hrs/week - Posted 12 minutes ago

As part of my studies, which begin in September 2023, I will have to carry out several projects including a website and/or logo. I am therefore looking for a **long-term** partnership so that these various projects can be carried out quickly.

WordPress

Web Design

Adobe Photoshop

Graphic Design

Logo Design

Adobe Illustrator

HTML

Proposals: Less than 5

Payment unverified ★★★★★ \$0 spent 📍 France Connects to apply: 16 Connects

WordPress: SEO Article & Blog Writer | News| Press Release



Fixed-price - Intermediate - Est. Budget: \$100 - Posted 2 hours ago

ATTENTION WRITERS! Are you an experienced and passionate article/blog content writer in the Blockchain, Cryptocurrency, NFT, and Web3, as well as in the Business, Finance and Entrepreneurship sectors? If yes, here is a project that's perfect for you. We are looking for someone to help us create, strategize and manage our articles/blogs on... [more](#)

News Writing

Content Planning

Press Release Writing

Search Engine Optimization

Article Writing

SEO Writing



Proposals: Less than 5

Payment verified ★★★★★ \$1K+ spent 📍 Philippines Connects to apply: 12 Connects

I'm looking for an SEO expert to handle building blogs in different niches from A to Z



Hourly - Expert - Est. Time: More than 6 months, 30+ hrs/week - Posted 2 hours ago

*** This is a **Long-term** Business *** I'm looking for an experienced SEO specialist to build profitable autopilot blogs from A to Z. I want to have different blogs in different niches, and they should return profit over time. The candidate: 1. Should understand this business model very well and should have already built blogs from A to Z in the past and earned from... [more](#)

WordPress

Search Engine Optimization

Content Writing

Blog Writing

Article Writing

SEO Writing

Blog Conte



Proposals: Less than 5

Payment verified ★★★★★ \$4K+ spent 📍 Jordan Connects to apply: 16 Connects

HOW YOUR PROPOSAL LOOKS TO THE CLIENT

Do you see the screenshot below? This is how your proposal looks to the client. Do you notice the number of characters that the client sees initially? Most of us waste those characters by introducing ourselves, stating our years of experience, and expressing how excited we are to apply to the project (client be like: Ek button ka color hi to change karwana hay. Is main kiya excitement hay?).

Most people use the same template to start their proposals and don't say anything about the project in the characters that show to the client initially. This is where you can stand out and throw a googly. For me, it's mostly asking a question or giving a hint to the solution in the first line of the proposal. That makes you stand apart from the rest, and the client notices something new and clicks on your proposal to read it further.

(To generate questions for a project, you can use my AI Question Generator (a free tool) on my website.)

Here is the proposal I sent to the last job I applied to (and won). Notice I didn't mention my name, experience, or skills. New clients don't care who you are. They only want to know if you can do the work or not.

"<Client Name>, Most likely the issue is with the mod_rewrite apache module. I will be happy to fix it for you. Shouldn't take more than an hour to resolve it."

[Hire](#)

\$10.00/hr

\$0 earned

Cover letter - Dear Hiring Manager, I hope this message finds you well. I am writing to express my interest in the Graphic Designer position currently available on Upwork. With my extensive experience in the field and a passion for design, I believe I...

[Maker](#)[Manufacturing & Construction](#)[Thumbnail](#)[Academic Editing](#)[Camera](#)[POS Terminal Development](#)[Poster](#)

ADVANTAGE OF APPLYING TO JOBS WITH UNVERIFIED PAYMENT METHODS

I have always preferred jobs with unverified payment methods because most are not going to apply on those. Sometimes, the client's payment verification is pending, and it eventually gets verified by the time you get the job.

GETTING “BEST MATCH” BADGE ON YOUR PROPOSAL

When a client receives proposals for a job on Upwork, a "**Best Match**" badge appears next to certain freelancers. This badge also serves as the default sorting option for clients when viewing proposals.

According to Upwork, freelancers receive this badge based on their work history and their fit for the job. However, as evident from the provided screenshot, some freelancers with this badge have no work history, and one even seems to be a fake account.

So, how did the freelancers in the screenshot earn this badge? Let's delve deeper:

When a client posts a job, they specify certain skills required for the position. These skills are listed below the job description.

Likewise, freelancers list specific skills when setting up their profiles. These skills can be seen in the screenshot, right below each freelancer's proposal.

Upon examining the job post and the freelancer proposals, I made some observations. However, these are simply my interpretations:

There are 4 areas Upwork considers when you submit a bid:

1. Your Profile Title
2. Your Profile Description
3. Your Skillset

4. Your Proposal

If 3 out of these 4 areas contain keywords from the skill set or job description specified by the client, you are likely to receive the "**Best Match**" badge.

For instance, the third proposal (which appears to be a fake account with a doll picture, a one-liner proposal, and no skills that match the job) in the screenshot did not list any matching skills. The individual seemed more aligned with programming than graphic design. However, the terms "graphic design" and "logo design" were present in their proposal. Additionally, "graphic design" was part of their profile title. Both of these skills were sought by the client. Their profile description also contained one keyword from the job description.

The person who was hired (also a best match) had 11 skills that matched the client's specified skill set. Their profile title and description also contained keywords related to the job. However, their proposal did not reference the job specifics.

Conclusion: When applying for a job, ensure your profile title, description, skill set, and proposal include the keywords from the job description to increase your chances of earning the "**Best Match**" badge. Good luck, but don't take my word for it. These are just my observations.

If you didn't understand, don't worry. I'll create a video to explain further.

BEST MATCH

Graphic Designing
Pakistan

\$10.00/hr

\$0 earned

Cover letter - Hello! I'm a creative graphic designer. I can carefully read and understand your above description regarding your need. You are in need of a YouTube thumbnail and cover photo etc so I'm right here for you. I can create creative and...

[Brochure Design](#) [Business Card Design](#) [Web Design](#) [Menu Design](#) [Graphic Design](#) [Digital Design](#) [Flyer Design](#) [F >](#)

BEST MATCH

YouTube Thumbnail & Graphic designer
Uzbekistan

\$10.00/hr

\$0 earned

📈 Rising Talent

Cover letter - Dear [REDACTED] My name is [REDACTED] I am writing to express my interest in the channel cover and thumbnail project you posted. As an experienced graphic designer, I am confident that I can deliver high-quality and visually appealing cover...

[YouTube Marketing](#) [Graphic Design](#) [Thumbnail](#) [Digital Design](#) [Photo Editing](#) [YouTube Development](#) [Photo Manipulation](#) [F >](#)

BEST MATCH

Graphic design /photographer
Algeria

\$5.00/hr

\$0 earned

Cover letter - Hello sir my name is [REDACTED] I'm graphic designer skilled in logo designing specially Here my previous work

[Data Analysis](#) [Python](#) [ASP.NET](#) [PHP](#) [React Native](#) [Photo Editing](#) [Laravel](#) [ETL Pipeline](#) [JavaScript](#) [R](#) [F >](#)

HAS YOUR UPWORK PROFILE STATUS CHANGED TO "PRIVATE"?

Has your Upwork profile status changed to "Private" due to inactivity, and now it no longer shows up in search results? No worries. Press a button and get the status changed to "Public". Here is the link:

Check this link and follow the instructions to make it public again: <https://support.upwork.com/hc/en-us/articles/115003975967-Profile-Changed-to-Private->

~~P.S. Don't experiment with the button if the status is already public. It will automatically generate a ticket, and Upwork might mistakenly change it from Public to Private. I did that from my account while helping out someone and panicked. Sent a couple of emails to Upwork asking them to ignore the requests. Lol.~~

AI QUESTION GENERATOR

During my years of freelancing, I've noticed that beginning your proposal with a question serves as a scroll-stopper. It captures the client's attention and compels them to delve further into your proposal.

I've developed a FREE tool that analyzes the job description you paste, whether it's from Upwork or any other freelancing platform. It then generates a list of up to 5 questions you can incorporate into your proposal, potentially enhancing your chances of securing the project.

This tool is especially valuable for those who craft their own proposals but struggle to identify suitable questions. It's important to note that this tool differs from my AI Proposal Writer, which composes complete proposals in a style similar to mine. Nonetheless, even including just a question in your proposal, without additional content, has resulted in me receiving positive responses from clients. Therefore, I encourage you to give this tool a try. Your feedback would be greatly appreciated.

Here is the link: <https://farazthewebguy.com/ai-question-generator/>

HOW CAN STAYING ONLINE ON UPWORK BE BENEFICIAL?

When a client posts a job, Upwork provides them with a list of freelancers to invite. If you are online and in the list, your chances of receiving an invitation can be higher, especially if the client wants to hire someone urgently. Telling this from the client's perspective.

WHY MY AI PROPOSAL WRITER TOOL OFTEN WRITES VERY SHORT PROPOSALS?

Some people have asked me why my AI proposal writer tool often writes very short proposals and why there should be additional fields to include the freelancer's name and qualifications.

My answer:

The tool writes short proposals because that's how I write them. The tool literally writes the proposals the same way I do. Yes, sometimes it tries to be smart and ignores my instructions. In that case, simply resubmit the form to get a new proposal.

The client doesn't give two hoots about who you are or what you have done in the past. They just want to know what you can do now and how it will help them with their project. This is very important, and that's why I don't mention anything about myself in my proposal, not even my name in most cases. The client can see that, and if they're interested, they can look at my profile to learn more about me.

Stick to the 80/20 rule. If you're unfamiliar with it, you can Google it to find out more.

HOW TO PRACTICE PROPOSAL WRITING SKILLS?

I only work on Upwork, so I didn't know about this until recently: If you want to work on your proposal writing skills, go to freelancer dot com website, click on any job you find interesting, open up your word editor, write your proposal, and then scroll down the job page to see the submitted proposals from other freelancers. Then you can compare your proposal with the proposals submitted by the top freelancers and see where you are lacking. You can even see the winning proposal!

STRUGGLING TO WIN A JOB ON UPWORK?

Try the tip below from a random dude endorsed by Upwork.



environment. While earning a decent income through part-time freelancing, I believe the possibility to double or even triple my income as a full-time freelancer is not out of the realm of possibility."

—Peter Ono

If you're new to freelancing on Upwork, you may want to charge less initially to build up your reputation, earn positive reviews, and have more samples for your portfolio. Once you've established yourself, you can start to raise your rates and charge new clients more as the demand for your services increases.

Pro Tip: "When you're just starting on Upwork, it's a good idea to begin with smaller projects. These projects will help you build your reputation on the platform, gain some positive reviews, and get some experience under your belt. That's how I also started. Additionally, the first 230 characters are the first part the client sees when they read your proposal, so when applying for a job, always make it about the client and their project in the beginning of the proposal and not about yourself."

—Faraz Ahmed



CONVERTING SHORT-TERM CLIENTS TO LONG-TERM CLIENTS

Are you ready to take your client relationships to the next level? The below is what I do:

RESPONSE TIME

1. Be lightning-fast in your responses to client inquiries. Show them you're always there to address their needs.
2. Keep your clients in the loop with frequent updates, especially when reaching important milestones. It builds trust and keeps them engaged.
3. Flexibility is key! Make yourself available during your client's preferred timings to enhance communication and collaboration.
4. When urgent issues arise, be proactive in resolving them promptly. Your clients will appreciate your efficiency and dedication.
5. One secret to success is underpromising and overdelivering. Exceed your client's expectations and leave them wanting more.

DRAWBACKS

While striving for excellence, it's essential to acknowledge potential challenges.

Work-life Balance Concerns

Devoting significant time and energy to clients may lead to burnout or a compromised work-life balance. It's crucial to find a healthy balance.

The Solution

The key lies in building a strong team. Start assembling a capable group of people as early as possible. By distributing the workload, you can avoid burnout and provide consistent support to your clients.

Remember, nurturing long-term client relationships is a journey that requires commitment and adaptability. By implementing these strategies, you'll be well on your way to turning short-term clients into loyal, long-term partners.

UPWORK JOB NOTIFICATIONS

If you want to receive email notifications for newly posted Upwork jobs, simply search for "**IFTTT**" on Google and link your Upwork RSS feed to the service. It's a free tool.

If you're unsure about generating an RSS feed or prefer instant desktop notifications, I have a video on my channel titled "**Upwork Job Notifications: No Extensions Required! Here's How**" that you can check out.

Here is the link to the video:

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=9EaTcDQ-Fil>

WHEN YOU DON'T RECEIVE A RESPONSE AFTER APPLYING FOR A JOB

Don't stress out when you don't receive a response after applying for a job. It's common for people to apply for multiple positions and not hear back from all of them, which can lead to feelings of disappointment. Instead of panicking, take a proactive approach. Start by checking if the client has made any hires for the job you applied to. Remember, not every client will hire for every position they post. If you've applied to ten jobs and the client has hired someone for only two of them, there's no need to worry. However, if they've made five hires, it's worth considering that your proposals may need improvement.

To determine if the client has made other hires, you can watch my video titled "**Upwork Pro Tips: Identifying Client Hires on Job Postings**" on my YouTube channel. The link is in the comments.

Here is the link to the video:

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=z0kWcZedTOc>

THE ROLE OF A GOOD PROFILE PICTURE

The profile picture you choose plays a crucial role in making a lasting impression on potential clients when you submit a proposal on Upwork. A well-chosen picture has the power to set you apart and attract the clients you desire for a successful freelance career. However, it's disheartening to observe that many profiles I've come across on Upwork have unappealing profile pictures.

To address this issue and enhance your professional image, I strongly recommend reading Upwork's helpful article on improving your profile picture. It's often the small details that make all the difference in creating a positive impact.

The link to the article:

<https://www.upwork.com/resources/how-to-guide-perfect-profile-picture>

HOW DO YOU ANSWER WHEN THE CLIENT ASKS WHY THE PROJECT WILL TAKE THAT LONG AND COST THAT MUCH ONCE YOU GIVE THEM YOUR ESTIMATE?

The below is an excerpt from an article written by me and posted by Upwork on their blog in 2015, addressing the aforementioned question:

Provide project details that will support your proposal's cost and timeline. Because development projects consist of many tasks, which are broken further into many smaller tasks, it's important to explain and "go deep" in development proposals. You can't simply say "It will take X amount of time and X amount of dollars to complete the project:"—break the project down into modules, then assign a timeframe to each module. Also, include what tools you'll use, what plugins you recommend they purchase, what infrastructure is needed to host the project, etc.

Tip: An easy way to do this is to track how long it took you to complete similar tasks in the past, then use those breakdowns to build new timelines. If something is of the exact same nature of a project I've done before, I already know how much time it will take me to do it again. If something is not exactly the same, but similar, then depending on the extent of it, I add or cut some hours. If something is totally new to me, then I search for any existing code snippets, classes, or ideas, then come up with my best estimate depending on my research and ability. If I'm uncertain about a task, then I add some cushion to it, just in case it takes longer than initially expected.

CREATING MULTIPLE UPWORK ACCOUNTS

Some people have asked me whether it would be better to create two Upwork accounts if they want to sell two different skills. Please don't do that as you will get banned.

Upwork introduced a feature a couple of years ago that allows you to create specialized profiles. With a specialized profile, you can tailor your unique skills to your audience on Upwork and create variations of your profile that showcase your experience within specific categories. For example, you can separate the work you've done as a mobile game developer from your work as a translator or graphic designer.

Here is the link with the info:

<https://support.upwork.com/hc/en-us/articles/115013750068-Create-a-Specialized-Profile>

PROPOSAL WRITING FOR GRAPHIC DESIGNERS

Although I don't provide graphic design services, I know what to look for when hiring a professional in this field.

For graphic designers, it's essential to showcase their past work right at the beginning of their proposals. Remember when I mentioned the importance of the first 230 characters?

If you're a graphic designer applying for a job that requires you to create a YouTube banner and a podcast cover, this is how you should start your proposal:

"Hi, here's a link to a YouTube banner and a podcast cover I created for another client: [link]. That should give you a taste of my talent as a graphic designer. [Add the rest of your proposal here along with your work process]."

If you haven't created any similar work in the past, take any piece you've done and adjust it to the client's requirements quickly. The idea is to be unique and attract the client's attention to your proposal. The first step is to make the client open your proposal, and if you follow the above, they will undoubtedly be curious to see what you can create.

Once they like your work, they'll initiate a conversation, which is the first step to getting the job. After that, it's your communication skills and rates that will decide the outcome.

In other words, don't talk about your experience and skills in the beginning. Nobody's interested in that until they see what you can do.

UPWORK BOOSTED PROPOSALS

I have been seeing a lot of people panicking over this. Please don't.

1. What was the situation before this feature existed? There were still proposals at the top above yours.
2. Do you think the client only sees the boosted proposals and chooses one from them?
3. Do you think the quality of the proposal does not matter and only the positioning does?

You need to change your mindset. Do you want to spend your whole life bidding on jobs day after day? I keep saying to focus on the long-term clients. You will just need a couple of long-term clients to have an excellent freelancing career and stay out of the rate race. Like I did.

INTERVIEW WITH UPWORK

I was the first Pakistani male to be spotlighted by Upwork in 2020. Below are all the questions they asked:

What is your specialty/area of expertise?

Web Development

How did you get started freelancing and how long have you been doing it? *

I started freelancing six years ago after I left my fulltime job because I didn't seem to go anywhere with my career and wanted something new to work on. The original plan was to take a break from work for a month or two to reenergize myself and think hard about what I wanted to do with my life. That's when I signed up on Upwork, just as an experiment, to see how the freelance marketplaces work. I bid on some projects and landed three jobs in the very first hour. Needless to say, I didn't look back since then.

Why did you decide to pursue freelancing instead of a traditional office position?

I loved being my own boss, setting up my own working hours, and only choosing the projects that excited me or challenged me. In the traditional office position, I didn't have that freedom and more often not, I got to do repetitive projects. Freelancing also saved me commute times, and I found myself more productive when working alone in my own space in quietness.

What is your favorite thing about working with clients you find on Upwork?

I get to meet new people, from different backgrounds, from different experiences, from different industries, and with projects with new technologies I haven't yet laid my hands on. Working with clients from different areas of life teaches me a lot about the world around me, their mindset, and the way of life.

If you were talking to a business owner who was considering choosing a freelancer to do a project for them, but wasn't sure about working with freelancers, what would you say to convince them that freelancers are a good choice?

I will convince them by telling how working with a freelancer can decrease their project cost. Because when it comes to working with an agency, the agency owner also adds their cut along with other miscellaneous company costs to the final project cost, increasing the project cost significantly. The communication is also very important because in a normal agency, you have a hierarchy through which the communication takes place (project manager -> developer -> project manager), and in an ill-managed agency, the communication is sometimes lost or misinterpreted in the process, resulting in a disaster final outcome. But, the same is not the case working with a freelancer. He is the only one you are communicating with, and he is the only one you are paying for the work.

What's your favorite or most unique project you've worked on for a client?

I've always been a backend developer before I started working as a freelancer and wasn't sure about my abilities as a frontend developer, but one day my existing client came to me and asked me if I could code a site in HTML from a given

design and integrate it with WordPress. Being me, who is always up for a challenge, I took on the job and ended up creating something which I am proud of. That project also opened the doors for me for the frontend development, and I could call myself a full-stack web developer.

How do you ensure your clients have a great experience with you?

Communication is the key. I keenly observe how the clients write and what terms they use to describe certain things, and then I try to speak to them in their own language making them feel at ease and understand things properly. I also own every project that I take and go beyond than the project scope to suggest them things that could help them make more money or save costs. I've noticed that even if the clients don't always follow your suggestions, they appreciate them a lot and keep coming back to you.

What are the advantages of partnering with a freelancer for businesses?

It will save you trouble from going through different hierarchies in an agency to get the work done, unlike working with a freelancer, where the communication will be faster, and the cost will be lesser.

What advice would you give a first-time client about working with freelancers?

Never look at the price or reviews first. First, look if the freelancer has the required skills, and if he understands the job. Don't get impressed with his experience and skill set. Those could be faked. Check if he really understands the job, asks the right questions, and shows you appropriate samples

of the work close to what you want to get done. Then look at his reviews, experience, and then finally the price.

Do you consider yourself a business owner? Why or why not?

I don't consider myself a business owner. I am an individual whom businesses hire on Upwork. I will feel like a business owner when I officially register a company and do my freelancing through that name.

CLIENTS RECOMMENDATION STAT

A very small tidbit about Upwork:

Your JSS (Job Success Score) updates approximately every two weeks, which is common knowledge.

However, the "Clients who would recommend you" section updates after every three completed jobs. Hence, it's important to check this stat after completing each job, as it could potentially indicate your next JSS, especially if the recommendation score decreases.

JOB INTERVIEWS

If you are getting profile views but no invites, try lowering your hourly rate slightly and observe the results for a couple of weeks. If you still don't receive any invites, repeat the process until you do.

FREELANCER PLUS PLAN OR CONNECTS

As a beginner, you might be wondering whether to purchase the Freelancer Plus plan or simply buy Connects. This is a common question I encounter.

Here's my advice: If you're new to the platform, I recommend starting with the Freelancer Plus plan for the first two to three months. Although this plan provides ~~20~~ 33 fewer connects and you'll likely need to purchase additional connects separately, the benefits outweigh this minor drawback. The Freelancer Plus Plan allows you to see the bids your competitors place on jobs. This insight is invaluable as it reveals the market rate in your niche and what others are charging for similar services. With this information, you can avoid placing bids that are either too high, risking job opportunities, or too low, leading to potential regrets.

Now, it's not officially stated, and I could be entirely mistaken, but I believe that the Freelancer Plus Plan might also enhance your profile ranking. While active project work, bidding, and staying online naturally boost your profile, the subscription might offer additional benefits. This is just a guess, but it makes business sense for Upwork to do it to encourage longer subscription commitments. However, take this with a grain of salt, as it's just a hypothesis.

UPWORK NOT SHOWING RELEVANT OR LATEST JOBS

The above is another common query I receive.

Never rely on the jobs Upwork shows you on your homepage. It may not show you all the possible jobs that you can do. In the past, this area was broken (it might still be), and people just kept waiting for the proper jobs to show up so they could apply. However, it's better to be proactive and find the jobs yourself. You can do that by clicking on the search box at the top right and entering the name of your skill.

And on that search page, you can use my free Chrome extension (<https://farazthewebguy.com/upwork-job-filter-google-chrome-extension/>) to quickly filter projects with short descriptions, making it easier for you to quickly read through and decide which projects to apply for before your competition does.

upwork Find Work ▾ My Jobs ▾ Reports ▾ Messages



Q Search search jobs here Jobs ▾ ?

MY JSS SUDDENLY DROPPED! I DIDN'T WORK ON ANY NEW PROJECTS OR RECEIVE ANY NEW REVIEWS!

I've received this query several times in the past few weeks.

Nothing in life is permanent:

Money comes and goes.

We grow old.

Day turns to night, and night to day.

Similarly, JSS (Job Success Score) is never static; it changes, even without recent activity.

Typically, changes in JSS occur when new contracts impact your score, or when older activities age out of the calculation. Upwork displays your best JSS from the 3-, 6-, 12-, and 24-month periods used for calculation, updating these time frames every two weeks.

For instance, a contract will no longer count in your six-month JSS window once it is six months and one day old.

Your JSS can change due to:

1. Receiving poor public or private feedback from clients.
2. Receiving very positive public or private feedback from clients.
3. Adding a higher-value job to your JSS, which outweighs lower-value jobs.

4. Past jobs no longer being considered as they fall outside the calculation timeframe.

UPWORK JOB SUCCESS SCORE UPDATE

DECEMBER 2023

Changes include:

1. Now you can earn a JSS after having two outcomes within a 24-month period as long as you've had outcomes with at least two unique clients during your time on Upwork. Previously, Upwork required at least four outcomes with two unique clients.
2. **Upwork is putting more emphasis on public feedback, which gives you more transparency into the outcomes that impact your score.** This also will give clients a deeper understanding of your strengths and weaknesses and how you performed on previous projects.
3. You will keep your Rising Talent badge even after you've earned a JSS, as long as you remain eligible or until you earn a Top Rated badge. In the past, once you earned a JSS your Rising Talent badge was removed.

UPWORK CLIENT SCAMS

This is important for newcomers on Upwork, as they are more prone to falling into the hands of scammers.

But before we delve into the details, note one thing:

Once you accept a contract, a client can leave private feedback, even if the job is completed without any work or the exchange of money. And this private feedback affects your JSS. This is where scammers try to blackmail you, saying that they will give you poor feedback if you don't do the work, and try to squeeze as much work from you as possible.

Now, here is the common scam that is going on nowadays:

Never accept a direct job offer. Think about it: why would someone offer you a job without even knowing you or talking to you about the job first? This is one of the common scams targeted at newbies and is mostly carried out by people using a stolen credit card. By the way, you will get paid, but once the real owner learns about the stolen card, they will call the bank, which will initiate a refund. In return, Upwork will refund the money, suspend the client, and in most cases, suspend you too! I have heard many incidents like this from people who were scammed by such clients.

So, never accept a direct job offer from someone unknown, and always do your due diligence (get complete project details) before accepting any offer from any client.

CRAFTING AN OUTSTANDING UPWORK PROFILE WITH CHATGPT

PROMPT FOR THE PROFILE DESCRIPTION

I want you to create an Upwork profile description for a WordPress developer that provides the services below. I want you to take care of a couple of things:

1. You should list down the service names, comma separated, at the start of the profile description. The reason for that is when a client searches for a profile, Upwork only shows it first 230 characters, so it's important for the client to see the services that freelancer offers at the top.
2. Also add some emojis with the services in the above point.
3. In the second para after the first and second points above, you can list down the service names and add short descriptions to it so the client knows what exactly the service entails.

Here are the keywords:
[KEYWORDS HERE]

PROMPT FOR THE PROFILE TITLE

Also suggest up to 5 Upwork profile titles for the above profile description.

A COUPLE OF THINGS I WOULD LIKE TO ADD:

1. After adding your skills, comma-separated, at the top, use three paragraphs to introduce yourself, describe your experience, or share anything about yourself, but don't use

any emojis. Too many emojis can make the description a pain in the eyes.

2. Don't optimize your profile if you are already getting views. However, if you are not receiving invites, try lowering your hourly rate a notch first and wait for a couple of weeks.

3. Wait and be patient for two weeks after making any changes to your profile.

SOME MISCONCEPTIONS ABOUT UPWORK PROFILE OPTIMIZATION

Upwork profile optimization is not like SEO (not anymore, at least) where you optimize your profile and expect it to rank on Upwork like Google.

Upwork puts emphasis on those profiles on their search page that are active on Upwork, which includes frequently bidding on projects, already working on projects, or paying Upwork for boosting the profile, availability badge, and pro plan. Obviously, Upwork is not going to show profiles that are not doing anything on the website because that's bad for business, as clients might not get responses from those inactive profiles. Upwork also rotates the search results every couple of weeks.

The profile optimization comes into play when your profile shows up in the search results. If your tagline and the starting description are attractive, the client will be attracted to your profile and view your profile.

So, profile optimization is not necessarily equal to ranking on Upwork search results. Your activity on the platform matters. For example, my own profile is not outstanding, but I still receive a good amount of views every week because I am doing projects on the platform.

Some sound principles to remember for ranking well in search are as follows (by Upwork):

1. Do good work for clients and establish good long-term relationships on Upwork.

2. Only apply to jobs to which you are qualified.

3. Be accurate in showcasing your abilities and skills on your contractor profile.

HOW DO I KNOW IF I AM READY FOR FREELANCING ON UPWORK?

Very simple.

First, visit Upwork and explore job listings in your area of expertise.

If you find yourself smiling broadly as you read each job description, feeling confident in your ability to handle real-world projects, then congratulations! You're ready for freelancing.

However, if your smile fades and your expression turns to that of someone who's just been told there's no Wi-Fi, it's a sign that you need to further develop your skills.

I never recommend immediately jumping onto freelancing platforms right after acquiring new skills and without solid work experience. To gain work experience, I have always recommended two things:

1. Do a job in a firm for at least 2 years to work on real-world projects and also learn about different aspects of business, like project management, business development, costs, etc.
2. Pick challenging projects in your niche category from Upwork job listings and start building on them for practice.

However, let's say you are well-versed in your skill, but your niche requires a portfolio to show to the client, and you don't have one of your own. In that case, I have always suggested offering your services for free on different freelancing groups to build your portfolio. There is also a high chance that if you do excellent work for someone for free, they will hire you the next time. Hence, you will get a direct client without even

using any freelancing platform. And later on, when you have a decent portfolio under your belt, you can also try your hands on freelancing platforms.

IS IT WISE TO BID ON JOBS THAT HAVE 50+ PROPOSALS?

Generally, it's not, if you are low on connects/budget. But I would still give it a try if:

1. It's a kind of job that I have done in the past, and I know exactly how much time it will take me to complete the job. Ideally, it should be a small project/task.
2. The client is taking zero or more than one interview. Sounds weird? Well, if the client is taking just one interview, then the chances are that he is probably going to go with that freelancer. Sometimes, it's predecided between the client and the freelancer that the client will post a job and hire that freelancer. I don't want to go into the details of why some people do that.
3. The client has viewed the job in the last 12 hours.

The most important part when applying to these types of jobs is going to be the first line of your proposal. The first line of the proposal should contain your price, time to complete the job, and the FOMO CTA. Here is a real example proposal of mine:

Hi,

I looked at the website, and it seems that some scripts are conflicting with each other. It should be fixed in an hour or two (\$xx-\$xx). I am available to fix the issue immediately if you hire me right now!

As far as my experience is concerned, I have been working on PHP and WordPress for the last 5+ years. I am also a Zend

Certified PHP Professional (the top PHP certification available in the market).

MY FREELANCING MANTRA WHEN I BEGAN FREELANCING

All you need is one client, just one, who provides regular work and becomes a long-term client. Then, everything will become easier. Just one client.

CAN I CLOSE A COMPLETED AND PAID JOB MYSELF IF THE CLIENT DOESN'T RESPOND TO MY REQUEST FOR CLOSURE AND FEEDBACK?

Keeping contracts open with no recent activity will not negatively affect your score. If you have contracts that are still open but no further work is required, you can either ask your clients to close them or choose to close them yourself. It's important to note that when you close a contract, the client is notified and has 14 days to provide feedback on the contract. If the client does not provide feedback within this period, it will not impact your score.

In my opinion, it's preferable to have the client close the job so that you can receive a review on your profile. Having too many jobs closed without client feedback might not reflect well on your profile.

AS A BEGINNER ON UPWORK, HOW DOES ONE IDENTIFY NEW CLIENTS THAT ARE GENUINE?

It comes with experience. You will read the job description, see their writing and their communication, and will easily be able to spot who is genuine or not. That's why I always recommend doing a job for a couple of years to work on some real-world projects after learning a skill.

But don't worry about them being genuine or not before applying to the job. Just apply and see how they communicate. Just never accept an offer until you have received 100% of the job details and the client's payment method has been verified by the time you receive the offer. If not, ask them to do so. If they are a legitimate client, they will, and you can accept the offer. If not, they might make excuses. If they do the latter, reject the offer. You'll waste your Connects, but you'll save yourself from a scam.

WHY FREELANCE WORK OFTEN SLOWS DOWN AT THE START OF THE YEAR

Many people have noticed a decline in profile views and job posts on Upwork related to their niche and have asked me about it. So, I thought I'd share some insights into why freelance work often experiences a downturn in January.

Post-Holiday Slowdown: Many businesses slow down during the holidays in December and take time to ramp back up in January. This can lead to a temporary reduction in demand for freelance services.

Budget Resets: Companies typically reset their budgets at the beginning of the year. It may take some time for them to allocate funds for freelance projects.

Strategic Planning: Early in the year, businesses are often involved in strategic planning for the year ahead, which might delay the start of new projects that require freelance help.

Vacation and Time Off: Some decision-makers in companies might be on vacation in early January, leading to delays in project initiation and hiring freelancers.

Economic Factors: Broader economic trends, such as a slow start to the fiscal year or economic downturns, can also impact the availability of freelance work.

Keep in mind that these are just common trends, and how much things slow down can change depending on the type of industry, and the specific skills you have as a freelancer.

INTRODUCING THE "UPWORK PROFILE OPTIMIZER"!

Are you ready to take your Upwork profile to the next level? Say hello to effortless optimization with my brand-new tool, the "Upwork Profile Optimizer."

WHAT IT DOES:

Analyzes Your Current Profile: Just copy and paste your existing Upwork profile description.

Provides Smart Corrections: Get insights on what needs improvement.

Suggests Powerful Titles: Stand out with catchy and professional profile titles.

Delivers a Polished Profile: Receive a corrected and optimized version of your profile, ready to impress!

Whether you're a seasoned freelancer or just starting out, this tool is designed to give you an edge in the competitive Upwork marketplace.

Try it out and see the difference!

Let's make your Upwork profile shine!

<https://farazthewebguy.com/upwork-profile-optimizer/>

BOOSTED PROPOSALS UPDATE JAN 26, 2024

BOOSTED PROPOSALS ARE NOW RESTRICTED TO QUALIFIED FREELANCERS

Note: I generally advise against using Boosted Proposals and have already mentioned my stance in a couple of my posts above.

Changes: Only freelancers who meet certain job criteria can access Boosted Proposals, ensuring they stand out to potential clients. The boost feature is displayed if you are considered a suitable match for the job, allowing eligible freelancers to see this option. Others may still apply through the standard process. The option to boost will be visible when submitting a proposal.

ADVANTAGES AND DISADVANTAGES OF WORKING WITH LONG-TERM CLIENTS ON UPWORK

First, let's talk about what Upwork classifies as long-term client relationships.

The clients with whom you work for at least three months in the past year and who pay you regularly are your long-term clients. This could be over one or multiple contracts and could be hourly or fixed-price work. The three months don't need to be consecutive, and having an open contract is irrelevant for this statistic. Getting paid regularly by a client is what counts toward your long-term client count.

Note: Having a high or low percentage here is not inherently good or bad, and not having it won't count against you.

Having long-term clients is obviously good for business, and you no longer need to participate in the bidding rate race anymore. The technical advantage of having a long-term client is that you also receive a temporary bonus added to your Job Success Score (JSS).

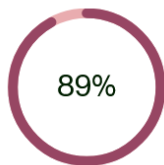
That means you actually don't have to close a contract and ask the client for a review to get the JSS. You automatically get that if you work on the same contract with a long-term client, by either creating multiple milestones or working on an hourly basis on different projects within the same contract. However, there could be one significant disadvantage of working on a single long-term contract, containing multiple projects, with a client:

If in the future there is a disagreement between you and a client, and the client becomes unhappy, he might give you a bad review, even though it was just the last project that went bad, and all the previous projects went well. That way, your JSS could take a huge hit! Because since it was a long-term contract with many transactions involved, and the JSS effect is based on the size of the contract, you might find yourself gasping for breath.

Even though I myself have been working with my clients on a single contract, containing multiple projects, we have a very strong relationship both outside and inside work. However, I wouldn't suggest others do everything in a single contract. So, my suggestion to you is to always create a new contract for each project. This way, the previous contract will close, and you will also receive feedback (there is also a feature called mid-contract feedback for long-term projects, but more on that later), and more positive feedback will look good on your profile.

Client relationships

- More than 3 months
- Less than 3 months



WILL IT CONFUSE THE CLIENTS THAT I AM WORKING IN TWO DIFFERENT FIELDS?

In a world where everyone is competing for attention, being clear and focused on what you do best can really help you stand out. This makes it easier for people who need your services to see how you can help them.

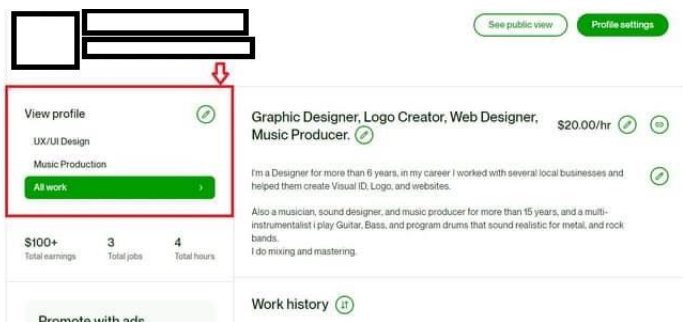
When your skills cover a lot of areas, like music, graphic design, and web design, it might make it harder for people to see you as a go-to expert in one specific field. People usually look for someone who can tackle their specific issue with a lot of skill. So, if your online profile or portfolio tries to appeal to everyone, it might end up confusing people or making them doubt whether you're the best fit for any one particular job.

For example, if I visit your profile as a client looking for a graphic designer, my reaction might be, "Hmm... Is this person skilled in music, graphics, or web design? Maybe they're not very strong in graphic design, and I'm looking for an expert."

I would most likely skip your profile. Nowadays, people don't have time to deliberate over options when they have so many available. It's crucial to be absolutely precise. I personally suggest focusing on one niche only. When creating specialized profiles, consider sticking to sub-niches within the same parent niche.

Choosing to focus on one area doesn't mean you have to give up all your other talents or hobbies. It's more about finding the best way to show what you're really good at and the kind of work you really want to do. As you become well-known and trusted for your main skill, you might even get the

chance to try out other things you like, with a group of clients who already support you. For example, my first task for a client was a WordPress job, but I have also worked on Shopify, Wix, Squarespace, Webflow, Silverstripe, and so on for them.



The screenshot shows a user profile page with several annotations. A red box highlights the 'View profile' section, which includes a 'View profile' link, a 'UX/UI Design' category, and a 'Music Production' category. A red arrow points to the 'All work' button. The profile summary shows 'Graphic Designer, Logo Creator, Web Designer, Music Producer' with a rate of '\$20.00/hr'. The bio states: 'I'm a Designer for more than 6 years, in my career I worked with several local businesses and helped them create Visual ID, Logo, and websites.' and 'Also a musician, sound designer, and music producer for more than 15 years, and a multi-instrumentalist (play Guitar, Bass, and program drums that sound realistic for metal, and rock bands. I do mixing and mastering.' The work history section is also visible.

See public view Profile settings

View profile

UX/UI Design

Music Production

All work

\$100+ Total earnings 3 Total jobs 4 Total hours

Promote with ads

Graphic Designer, Logo Creator, Web Designer, Music Producer. \$20.00/hr

I'm a Designer for more than 6 years, in my career I worked with several local businesses and helped them create Visual ID, Logo, and websites.

Also a musician, sound designer, and music producer for more than 15 years, and a multi-instrumentalist (play Guitar, Bass, and program drums that sound realistic for metal, and rock bands. I do mixing and mastering.

Work history

WHAT YOU CAN AND CANNOT SELL ON UPWORK

Upwork operates as a marketplace for services, meaning direct sales of accounts or channels are not permitted.

However, you can offer your services to work a specified number of hours for a client to organically develop and monetize a channel for them. In essence, it's your time and effort that should be marketed.

LOGGING TIME FOR FIXED-PRICE CONTRACTS

Did you know there's an option in the Upwork Time Tracker app to log time for fixed-price contracts?

But what's the benefit of logging hours for a fixed-price contract, you might ask.

I use the time tracker to record hours on a fixed-price contract to keep track of my productivity levels. It serves no other purpose. I have used the option from time to time just to get a measure of how long it takes me to complete a particular project. It helps so that in the future, I can estimate that a certain task might take x amount of time, or it takes me xxx hours to complete a specific task.

Be aware that if you choose to log hours on a fixed-price contract, the client can see the screenshots for the time that is recorded (if they ever care to look). However, as clients don't expect anything to be there and nothing alerts the client to the fact that you tracked time, there is literally no reason why a client would look at the work diary of a fixed-rate contract.

SAFEGUARDING YOURSELF AGAINST FREELANCE SCAMS

A word of advice: When working with a new client, never purchase anything (such as domains, hosting, plugins, software) on behalf of the client with the promise of being paid later on Upwork. Doing so will save you from many scams.

I have worked with my clients for years, some for even a decade. While we trust each other, I still insist they make any necessary purchases for a website project. One rule for all.

HOW CAN MY UPWORK AI TOOLS BE USED ON FIVERR?

Some individuals have found creative ways to use the tools I created specifically for Upwork on Fiverr as well.

For example:

1. You can use my AI question generator tool to ask intelligent questions related to the project from the clients in your inbox.
2. You can use my AI proposal tool to respond to the project descriptions sent by clients in your inbox.

LAST VIEWED BY CLIENT NO LONGER AVAILABLE?

The "Last viewed by client" section refers to the time when the client last reviewed or interacted with the applicants for this job, but sometimes you don't see it on some job posts.

As per Upwork, it'd only show for a job post that was viewed by the client AFTER it has been posted in the marketplace. Earlier, their systems were recording the last view by the client as the same time when they posted the job, and that information wasn't helpful. It's obvious they viewed the job when they posted it. Now, this timestamp will show when the client viewed their job after it was posted.

Activity on this job

Proposals: ? 15 to 20

Last viewed by client: ? 15 minutes ago

Interviewing: 8 **missing?**

Invites sent: 0

Unanswered invites: 0

IDEAL SUCCESS RATE FOR UPWORK PROPOSALS: VIEWS, INTERVIEWS, AND HIRES

What does the ideal success rate look like on Upwork when it comes to your proposals getting seen, getting you interviews, and getting you hired?

People often post their Upwork stats asking for feedback on how well they're doing. Here are the benchmarks I like to use. Remember, these are just my personal viewpoints - you don't have to stick to these, and it's okay if you see things differently. These benchmarks simply reflect my observations.

1. If 30% or more of the clients you send proposals to view your proposal, it means you're pretty good at writing proposals!
2. If, out of those who viewed your proposals, 30% or more invite you for an interview, it shows you're choosing the right clients to propose to!
3. And if 50% or more of those interviews turn into jobs, you're doing great at communicating your worth.

Overall, if you're getting hired for 5% or more of the jobs you apply for on Upwork, you're doing really well.

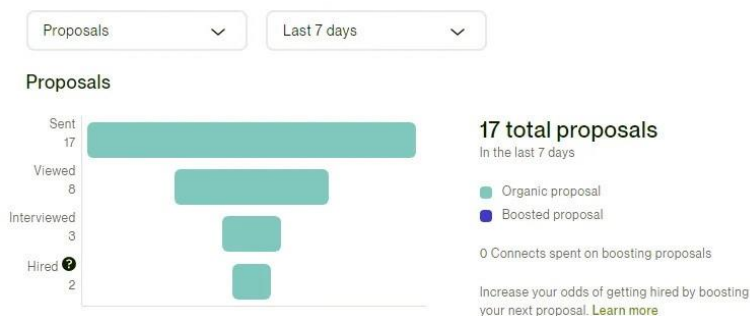
Remember:

1. Not every client is going to view yours or anyone's proposal for that matter.

2. Not every client who views your proposal is going to interview you or anyone for that matter.

3. Not every client who interviews you is going to hire you or anyone for that matter.

Not every client who posts jobs on Upwork will hire. This is very important to remember. So don't get depressed if you don't get hired because the chances are that no one else might have got hired either. That's why I always suggest to keep checking the job postings to see if the client has hired someone else. Only then can we assess ourselves and see what we could have improved.



TAKING ADVANTAGE OF UPWORK HOURLY PAYMENT PROTECTION

Always ensure that you write detailed memos when logging hours for an hourly contract. If you don't, you might not get paid if there is an issue with your client's payment method or in the event of a dispute. This happened to me once, but Upwork still paid me out of courtesy, and the client resolved the credit card issue later, so everything was eventually settled. However, it's crucial to always write detailed memos for the work you do, especially when working with new clients, and always log hours using the Upwork time tracker app.

 (Upwork Help Center)

Mar 4, 2:12 AM PST

Dear Faraz,

We are writing to inform you that your client's payment was unsuccessful for the week of February 16, 2020 – February 22, 2020 on the following contract:

Contract ID#:

Client Name:

Anytime a client's payment is not completed, Upwork will review the Work Diary and reverse any billed time that does not meet Upwork's Hourly Protection criteria.

During our review we found that some or all of the hours billed did not meet the criteria due to insufficient or no memos recorded in your Work Diary.

We would like to use this as an opportunity to send you a courtesy notice of the policy instead of reversing payment back to your client. Please note that if there are other issues with your work diary you will receive a separate notification with the reversal reason listed.

Having detailed memos related to the work being performed ensures your client is aware of the tasks being completed and is also a requirement for Hourly Protection. Going forward, any hours not logged in accordance with the policy will be reversed.

For a more detailed explanation of Upwork's Hourly Protection policy, please visit the following link:

<https://upwork.zendesk.com/entries/23116462-Upwork-Hourly-Protection-for-Freelancers>

If you have any further questions, please don't hesitate to ask. .

HOW TO ADJUST YOUR UPWORK BID STRATEGY: SHOULD YOU BID LOWER THAN YOUR COMPETITORS?

Note: The following recommendations are based on my personal experience and are not universal truths.

1. If it's a new client posting their first project, look at the client's budget and bid a little lower, and always bid on small projects that you can do in an hour or two. I am a big advocate of bidding on smaller projects posted by new clients (with no past projects or payment history) for a few reasons:

- a) If they turn out to be a scam, you wouldn't lose much.
- b) Many freelancers won't bid on their projects because they don't have any past history, so you will face less competition.
- c) If they turn out to be legit, really like your work, and have more work in the future, you may have struck gold in the form of a long-term client. This formula has worked for me so many times.
- d) A small first project can be a good way for you and your client to earn each other's trust before continuing on with bigger projects.

2. If it's an established client, you can bid according to how much time it will take you to do the job. You can also look at the client's past history, the amount they have paid, their average hourly rate, and adjust your bid accordingly. However, try justifying your bid price, like what you will be providing for the price you are charging. Break down the

project into different modules. You should always do that when bidding on big projects.

HOW DOES UPWORK CALCULATE THE NUMBER OF CONNECTS REQUIRED FOR EACH JOB?

Upwork calculates the number of Connects needed based on the projected job value -- determined using the estimated job duration and budget amount -- as well as marketplace demand.

WHAT DOES THE ABOVE MEAN?

Short-term/lower-paid jobs are supposed to cost fewer Connects, whereas higher-priced/longer-term jobs cost more. Sometimes, Upwork may lower the number of Connects needed to encourage more freelancers to submit proposals if the job isn't getting sufficient interest. In this case, if you submitted a proposal shortly after the job was posted, you might be required to use more Connects than someone who submits a proposal a few days later, for example. Similarly, if demand is too great, Upwork may increase the number of Connects needed.

WHAT'S THE BENEFIT FOR A SERIOUS FREELANCER?

Many jobs have a large number of applicants, making it difficult for the clients (I am one, and it's painful) to sort through the proposals. If there are fewer people applying because it costs more Connects, it can significantly increase your chance of getting hired.

HOW TO FIND JOBS WITH A LOWER NUMBER OF CONNECTS?

Experiment with the following filters by selecting one or all filters to search for jobs on the job search page:

- 1) Fixed-Price: Less than \$100
- 2) Project length: Less than one month
- 3) Hours per week: Less than 30 hrs/week

But it's not a perfect system, so sometimes you'll see Connect charges that make little sense.

WANT TO BECOME A FREELANCING SUPERSTAR IN JUST A WEEK?

Here's a wild idea: pretend you're a client instead of a freelancer.

First off, pick a simple task from whatever you're working on right now. It doesn't have to be anything fancy, just something you need to get done. Then, jump onto a freelancing site and put up a job post for it. This bit's kinda fun because you get to see what it's like on the other side of the table.

As people start applying, take a good look at how they pitch themselves. You'll learn a ton about what makes a freelancer stand out. Then, it's interview time. Chatting with them is a goldmine of insights on what questions to ask and how to spot the real deal.

Choosing someone and explaining the task to them is next. This is where you get to practice being super clear about what you need – a skill that's super important when you're the one doing the freelancing.

Now, the real test: checking their work. Seeing things from a client's point of view helps you understand what quality really means. And when it's all done and dusted, wrapping up the project teaches you about ending things on a good note, maybe with some useful feedback.

Doing this whole act-like-a-client stunt teaches you heaps about what clients want and how to be better at meeting those needs. Plus, figuring out where you might be going wrong is way easier this way than if you spent years just freelancing on your own. Trust me, it's a game-changer.

UNDERSTANDING UPWORK'S AVAILABILITY BADGE

Do you think turning on the Availability badge improves your ranking in the Upwork search results? Think again.

The Availability Badge does not impact where you appear in search results. That's right. If you're not appearing in Upwork search results, then turning the badge on won't magically make you appear in them.

It works best for freelancers who already receive a high number of profile views from search results. By activating it, you signal to clients that you're available for more work. While using the badge alone may not be beneficial, combining it with staying online as much as possible can offer more advantages. Clients can see your Available badge and your online status, which may make them more inclined to visit your profile.

Additionally, when clients search for freelancers to invite to a job after posting a job, they can filter through the Availability Badge (see the image in the next article) to see who's available for work right now. This is where you may appear, regardless of whether you show up in general search results or not.

So, should you turn it on? As a beginner, you shouldn't. However, if you have a 100% Job Success Score (JSS), regardless of whether you're top-rated or not, and you appear in the general Upwork search results, then activating it may increase your views further, thus enhancing your chances of receiving interviews. Experiment with it and see if it works for you.

THE TRUTH ABOUT PROFILE BOOSTING

Should you boost your Upwork profile? Do you think boosting your profile pushes you to the top of search results? Oops! No.

After posting a job, clients are prompted to invite freelancers to submit a proposal. If your profile is boosted, you'll appear as one of the top profiles on the list when Upwork prompts clients to send invites, and no Connects are needed to submit a proposal if you are invited. That's the only place your profile appears at the top if you boost it. The same doesn't happen in the general search results.

Should you boost your profile? As a beginner, no. But if you have a 100% JSS, you can take a chance, because it will only cost you Connects when the client clicks on your profile. Good luck.

The screenshot displays the Upwork web interface. At the top, the navigation bar includes the Upwork logo, links for Jobs, Talent, Reports, and Messages, a search bar, and user profile icons. Below the navigation bar, a job post titled "Graphic design for hire" is shown, with a green banner indicating "Reach 6x more Top Rated talent" and a button to "upgrade this job". The job post has four tabs: "VIEW JOB POST", "INVITE FREELANCERS" (highlighted in green), "REVIEW PROPOSALS (0)", and "HIRE (0)". Below the tabs, a search bar is visible with the text "Search" and a magnifying glass icon. To the right of the search bar are buttons for "Available now" and "Filters". Below the search bar, the text "Advanced Search" is displayed. The search results show two freelancers: Lee K. (Boosted) and Shriya B. (Boosted). Lee K. is a "Principal Variation Orchestrator" and Shriya B. is a "Principal Integration Orchestrator". Both profiles include a profile picture, a status indicator (Boosted), a cover letter, and a button to "Invite to job".

THE UNSEEN BENEFIT OF BEING ONLINE ON UPWORK

When it comes to Fiverr, clients can filter freelancers by online status if they need any urgent work. Upwork doesn't have such a filter.

However, staying online on Upwork does have its advantages:

1. If you are getting good profile views from search results, and the client also finds you online when he is looking at the search results, then he might be inclined to talk to you first. Combining being online with the Availability badge may further increase your chances.
2. If you send a proposal to a job and remain online, when the client comes back to see the job and read the proposals, likes your proposal, and also sees you are online, then he might be inclined to message you first.

MAXIMIZING YOUR UPWORK PROFILE VISIBILITY

Is it possible to receive profile views on Upwork without submitting any proposals? The answer is both yes and no.

Yes, if you already have clients on Upwork and are receiving regular payments. This indicates active participation, which Upwork rewards by increasing your visibility in search results. Conversely, the answer is no if you have recently created your account and have not secured any jobs within 90 days. Under these circumstances, Upwork will set your account to private, making it invisible in search results.

In essence, the more active you are on Upwork—whether through submitting proposals or working with existing clients—the more your profile will appear in search results. Merely optimizing your profile is insufficient if you are not engaging in any significant activities on Upwork or subscribing to the Freelancer Plus Plan.

Attached are my profile views for the last 30 days, demonstrating consistent visibility over the past year despite having submitted only two proposals. My continuous project work has been crucial for maintaining this visibility.

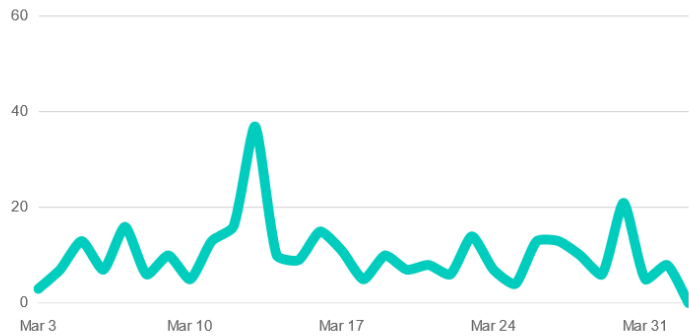
Therefore, do not solely focus on profile optimization. Upwork will not significantly feature your profile in search results if your activity level on the platform is low. In subsequent posts, I will share the precise bidding strategy and the necessary investment (in terms of connects) that beginners should consider if they wish to follow my client acquisition strategies on Upwork.

Profile metrics 7 hours ago

Last 30 days

Profile views Invites Impressions and clicks

315 profile views



- Available now badge is off
- Available now badge is on

[My profile](#)



With the **availability badge**, you can signal to clients that you're ready for new work now.

CAN I PERMIT THE CLIENT TO COMMUNICATE WITH ME OUTSIDE OF UPWORK AFTER SECURING THE CONTRACT?

Never— and I cannot stress this enough—never communicate with someone outside of Upwork if it is your first time working with them. It is crucial to make it absolutely clear that all communication for the first project must strictly occur on Upwork. This approach will protect you from scams and ensure that all communication is documented on the Upwork platform, should the client make any unreasonable demands. If the client does not agree to communicate on Upwork, consider it a significant red flag and avoid working with them.

HOW MANY CONNECTS SHOULD A NEWCOMER ON UPWORK PURCHASE?

First, make sure you have gone through my Upwork guide or watched my videos to learn my bidding strategy. If you haven't, stop here.

In short:

1. Place your bids between 3 AM and 9 AM Pakistan Time to face less competition.
2. Go for jobs posted by new clients who are offering their first project - they are less crowded.
3. Aim for small projects similar to the ones you have done before. If a job is a scam (check my tips to avoid scams), you won't lose much. But if it is a real, good job and the client comes back for more, you are in luck (and you won't have to keep bidding all the time)! Small jobs also need fewer of those "connects" Upwork uses. Use the link below to find those kinds of jobs and use my Job Filter Chrome extension to narrow your search.

https://www.upwork.com/nx/search/jobs/?amount=0-99&client_hires=0&duration_v3=week&proposals=0-4&sort=recency&t=1&workload=as_needed

By now, you should get the gist of how I bid. As for how many proposals to send, stick to 2 a day, maybe 3 max. Because we are being picky, you might have to wait and keep refreshing to find the right job. I have mentioned a tool in my videos that alerts you to new jobs. It is free to download and use, no signup required.

We are also not going after any job that costs more than 10 connects. So, if you are sending out 60 proposals a month and each uses up to 10 connects, that is about \$90 a month. Plan to keep this up for at least 3 months before deciding if it is working for you. I believe that if you follow this strategy, you will land long-term clients and won't need to bid so much. People who have bought my Paid Upwork Training Video get this. Not saying you have to buy it—it is basically a summary of everything important I have said, but it includes some extra tips and screenshots I do not share publicly. Additionally, you will receive an invitation to join my Paid Upwork WhatsApp Group, where I will share all the secret insights with you first before possibly releasing them to the public later on.

HOW CAN YOU TELL IF YOUR PROFILE APPEARS IN THE UPWORK SEARCH RESULTS?

It's simple. Copy a phrase from your Upwork profile description and paste it into the search box. If your profile appears, then congratulations, you are indexed in the Upwork search results.

However, when clients search for freelancers on Upwork, the profiles they see in their search results can vary significantly from one client to another, even with similar search queries.

This variation occurs because Upwork's search algorithm randomizes the search results for different clients to give everyone a chance to be seen by clients.

SHOULD YOU CREATE A SPECIALIZED PROFILE?

If you ask me, my answer would be no. By now, you should have noticed that the advice I give is somewhat unconventional.

Here's why you shouldn't use a specialized profile:

1. When a client searches for a freelancer using a keyword, Upwork searches for that keyword in the main profile and brings up your main profile only, so you are not getting any benefit there for your specialized profile.

2. Your specialized profile only appears when a client searches for your profile by using the category filter. ~~But here's the twist: even though the search results show your specialized profile title and description, clicking on it opens your main profile by default, not the specialized profile, creating significant confusion for the client. Most clients won't even notice the specialized profiles filter on the left side and will close your profile.~~

~~Also, if your specialized profile has a lower rate on the search results page, but your main profile, which opens by default, has a different and higher rate, that could also immediately discourage the client when they open your profile.~~

~~Clients have a large pool of freelancers to choose from and may not notice or bother with the specialized profiles filter available on your profile details page. Also, seeing different profile details than the one they see on the search results page might confuse a non-technical client, prompting them to skip your profile.~~

Keep your profile simple, stick to the main profile, and focus on one niche only. If you wish to talk about multiple niches, ensure they belong to the same parent niche. Discussing different, unrelated skills can also confuse clients, leading them to believe you might outsource the work to others and may not be an expert in anything, or at least not in the niche they are interested in hiring you for.

The only benefit of specialized profiles is when you send a lot of proposals. In that case, your specialized profile appears to clients by default when they read your proposal. However, if you aim to receive more invitations, I would personally avoid specialized profiles and make my main profile very precise and simple, ensuring that anyone reading my profile will have no doubts about my skills, nor will they get confused when they open the cover of the book, aka your profile details page.

[Open proposal in a new window](#)

5	***	—	\$50.00
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View profile

Proofreading

Copy Editing

All work

Copy Editing

\$800+

Earnings

6

Jobs

All stats

\$1K+

Total earnings

11

Total jobs

Expert Copyeditor

\$15.00/hr

Specializes in Copy Editing

I have several years of copywriting, editing, and proofreading experience, from academic work to magazine articles. I enjoy copyediting and proofreading, and am open and adaptable to all types of projects.

Work history

Completed jobs (6)

Editing and proof-reading for scholarly manuscripts

Sep 22, 2021 - Oct 5, 2022

No feedback given

\$405.00

Fixed price

WHAT SHOULD YOUR MAIN GOAL ON UPWORK BE?

Your main goal on Upwork should not merely be to bid on projects, win those projects, complete them, and then repeat the cycle.

Instead, your primary objective should be to secure long-term clients in the form of businesses. This way, you can escape the bidding race and focus on your work without worrying about where your next project will come from.

Even before I sent my first bid a decade ago, I knew I needed to do the above. Nowadays, I work more as a full-time remote worker for my clients rather than as a freelancer. Upwork has become merely a medium for me to receive payments—nothing more. :)

NOT GETTING ENOUGH PROFILE VIEWS ON UPWORK?

It could be that your profile's hook isn't strong enough.

Introducing the Upwork Profile Hook Generator! Simply input your profile title, and the tool will craft up to three catchy hooks tailored to your niche. The Upwork Profile Hook Generator is designed to emphasize quantifiable benefits, which are crucial for attracting potential clients. By including specific numbers and statistics in the hooks, such as percentages of increased sales or reductions in bounce rates, freelancers can showcase the tangible value they bring to the table. This not only grabs the attention of clients but also provides them with concrete evidence of the potential return on investment.

<https://farazthewebguy.com/upwork-profile-hook-generator/>

Your Hooks:

1. 🚀 Drive sales and grow your audience on TikTok & Instagram with my proven strategies and scripts that have generated over \$50,000 in revenue for clients.
2. 💡 Increase engagement and brand awareness on social media platforms by hiring me as your expert strategist and scriptwriter – my work has led to a 200% boost in conversions.
3. 🌟 Maximize your ROI on TikTok & Instagram by tapping into my expertise as a strategist and scriptwriter, which has helped clients achieve a 300% increase in online visibility and sales.

Introducing the Upwork Profile Hook Generator! Simply input your profile title, and the tool will craft up to three catchy hooks tailored to your niche. The Upwork Profile Hook Generator is designed to emphasize quantifiable benefits, which are crucial for attracting potential clients. By including specific numbers and statistics in the hooks, such as percentages of increased sales or reductions in bounce rates, freelancers can showcase the tangible value they bring to the table. This not only grabs the attention of clients but also provides them with concrete evidence of the potential return on investment. Say hello to more leads, more clients, and greater success on Upwork!

Additionally, you can enhance your profile further with the [Upwork Profile Optimizer Tool](#).

TikTok & Instagram Expert | Strategist & Scriptwriter

Submit

SHOULD WE UPDATE OUR UPWORK PROFILE REGULARLY?

If you're not receiving at least 60 profile views every 30 days on Upwork, then it's definitely time to update your profile with a new hook line. Feel free to use my free Upwork Profile Hook Generator tool that I've created.

<https://farazthewebguy.com/upwork-profile-hook-generator/>

P.S. Many individuals have reported that after updating their profiles following my guidelines, they experienced a boost in views and landed an interview within 24 hours. Is it a coincidence? :)

HOW TO DELETE A SPECIALIZED PROFILE?

If you have only one specialized profile, you will not see the option to delete or unpublish it.

However, you can create a new profile, keep it in draft mode, and then remove the first one. Let me know if that works for you.

THE TRUTH ABOUT UPWORK: HOW TO SUCCEED BY BEING PROACTIVE

I don't have money to buy connects. What can I do to receive project invitations or encourage clients to buy my projects from the Project Catalog?

Upwork rewards freelancers who are active on the platform by sending proposals, responding to messages, and completing projects. So, if you just create your profile and projects and wait for clients to come to you, it's unlikely to work.

Here's some truth about Upwork: Upwork doesn't want too many freelancers on their platform. They prefer that most freelancers leave because there are already too many. They want only those freelancers who are serious about their business. Upwork is focusing more on quality than quantity because that's what the clients want. No one wants to receive 100 proposals from low-quality freelancers.

Personally, I don't have any projects in the project catalog. I also don't worry about invites and haven't even optimized my profile. If I need work, I send proposals instead of hopelessly waiting for projects to come to me. It would be nice if clients sent me invitations and bought my projects, but I would never depend on external factors to secure work. I'm the kind of person who likes to take matters into my own hands.

"UPWORK SKILLS EXPORTER" CHROME EXTENSION

This tool allows users to analyze and export the most in-demand skills from job postings to strategically select the permitted 15 skills for their profile.

By identifying these skills, freelancers can optimize their profiles to align with market needs, thereby gaining a competitive edge. This helps boost their profile's visibility, and they even receive more responses to their cover letters because this strategy often labels their profile as "Best Match."

The extension works by extracting skills from listings, deduplicating them, counting their frequency, and exporting the data to a CSV file.

Here is the link to download the extension:

<https://farazthewebguy.com/upwork-skills-exporter-google-chrome-extension/>

	A	B
1	Skill	Times Found
2	PHP	6
3	JavaScript	4
4	MySQL	4
5	CSS	3
6	API	3
7	Laravel	3
8	Web Development	3
9	Web Design	2
10	Bootstrap	2
11	HTML	2
12	jQuery	2
13	WordPress	2
14	Magazine	1
15	Adobe InDesign	1
16	Canva	1
17	Landing Page	1
18	Website	1
19	Layout Design	1
20	Graphic Design	1
21	Packaging Design	1
22	Adobe XD	1
23	UX & UI	1
24	Email Design	1
25	App Design	1
26	Ebook Design	1
27	Newsletter	1
28	HTML5	1
29	CSS 3	1
30	Discord Bot Development	1
31	...	...

SUPER SECRET UPWORK JOB SEARCH LINK GENERATOR

Find jobs that require fewer connects and have less competition.

<https://farazthewebguy.com/upwork-job-search-link-generator/>

Password: super@347

If it works for you, great! If it doesn't work for you, it doesn't work for you. Don't tell me in the latter case. It's not supposed to work officially anyways. 😊

CAN I SHARE MY EMAIL ADDRESS WITH A CLIENT ON UPWORK BEFORE THE CONTRACT STARTS?

Yes, you can.

BUT!

You cannot communicate outside of Upwork before the contract starts.

The keyword here is "communicate."

But you can share your email address with the client if you need to get access to systems so you can scope a project. Examples would be:

1. GitHub/Bitbucket/GitLab or other code repositories
2. Google/Facebook or other ad analytics programs
3. QuickBooks or other bookkeeping/accounting programs
4. Cloud drive folders
5. Online e-signature programs
6. Website hosts or builders

You'll still need to keep all your communication on Upwork until the contract starts. If someone asks for your contact information for one of the reasons above, but then uses it to communicate with you about the job or payment, they'd be breaking Upwork's rules.

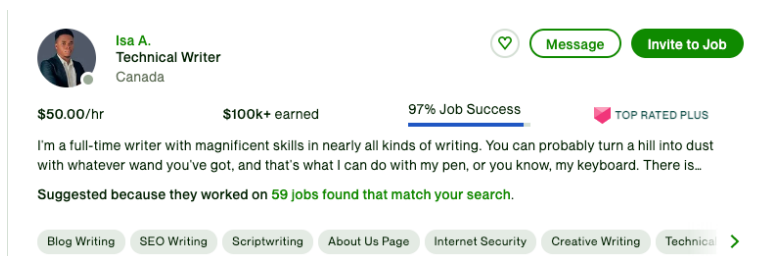
I AM A TOP-RATED FREELANCER, BUT I AM NOT RECEIVING AS MANY INVITATIONS AS I USED TO

Upwork has changed its UI in case you haven't noticed. Here are two screenshots comparing the old and new Upwork freelancer search layouts. Do you notice any differences?

In the old layout, the Top Rated Plus label is quite prominent. However, in the new layout, it appears as a small icon over the profile picture.

When you scroll through the profiles in the new layout, it's not immediately obvious who is top-rated or not. Most clients may not notice the icon or understand what it means. However, the Job Success Score and other badges are very prominent and might now be the most important metric. It seems that by making this change, Upwork is trying to give every freelancer, top rated or not, a better chance of gaining visibility and securing interviews.

OLD:



The screenshot shows a freelancer profile for Isa A., a Technical Writer from Canada. The profile includes a circular profile picture, a heart icon, and two buttons: "Message" and "Invite to Job". Below the profile information, the hourly rate is listed as \$50.00/hr, and the total earnings are \$100k+. The Job Success Score is 97%, represented by a blue progress bar. A "TOP RATED PLUS" badge is visible. The profile description reads: "I'm a full-time writer with magnificent skills in nearly all kinds of writing. You can probably turn a hill into dust with whatever wand you've got, and that's what I can do with my pen, or you know, my keyboard. There is...". Below the description, it says "Suggested because they worked on 59 jobs found that match your search." At the bottom, there are several tags: "Blog Writing", "SEO Writing", "Scriptwriting", "About Us Page", "Internet Security", "Creative Writing", and "Technical", followed by a right-pointing arrow.

Isa A.
Technical Writer
Canada

Message Invite to Job

\$50.00/hr \$100k+ earned 97% Job Success TOP RATED PLUS

I'm a full-time writer with magnificent skills in nearly all kinds of writing. You can probably turn a hill into dust with whatever wand you've got, and that's what I can do with my pen, or you know, my keyboard. There is...

Suggested because they worked on 59 jobs found that match your search.

Blog Writing SEO Writing Scriptwriting About Us Page Internet Security Creative Writing Technical >

NEW:



Quadri A. United States

SEO Content Writer | Article Writer | Copywriter | On-Page SEO

\$15/hr



99% Job Success

\$200K+ earned



Available Now



Offers Consultations

Blog Writing

Blog Content

SEO Writing

SEO Keyword Research

Search Engine Optimization

Article Writing

+9

Hello! I am Bashir Alausa Abdur Quadri, an expert SEO content writer, with over seven (7) years of extensive experience. I specialize in writing SEO web content, blog posts, legal articles, marketing articles, health articles, CBD articles, financial articles. Also, I have...

Quadri A. has worked 100 jobs related to your search.

SHOULD YOU LIST ONE SKILL OR MORE IN YOUR UPWORK PROFILE TITLE?

I am a strong advocate of focusing on a single skill or subniche in your Upwork profile title and description. In the midst of numerous freelancers on platforms like Upwork, you stand a better chance of being noticed if your profile precisely matches what the client is searching for.

When a client posts a job or looks for a freelancer, and your profile title and description perfectly align with their needs, you increase your chances of receiving those elusive invitations. Often, when people share screenshots in various freelancing groups showcasing the high number of profile views and interviews they receive, I notice that most of them have concentrated on a single subniche in their profiles.

For example, suppose a client posts a job for speed optimization on their WordPress website, and Upwork suggests the following four profiles (for the sake of this example, assume they are all top-rated and charge the same rate):

Profile 1 Title:

"WordPress Speed Optimization - PageSpeed - GTMetrix - Core Web Vitals"

Profile 2 Title:

"Speed Optimization Expert WordPress | Shopify | PHP | Webflow | CWV"

Profile 3 Title:

"Shopify Speed Optimization WooCommerce Speed WordPress PageSpeed INP"

Profile 4 Title:

"Web Designer | Elementor Designer | WordPress Designer | SEO"

I would be inclined to choose the first one because it addresses the exact and only thing I need for my project. My rationale is that since he focuses solely on one thing, he must be an expert in it.

However, I am not suggesting that you should entirely discard your other skills if you are proficient in them too. You can always upsell them after completing a client's project. For instance, if you are skilled at building websites and also proficient in SEO, keep your profile focused on website building to attract clients looking for this service. After building the website, you can then offer your SEO services. But your main profile should primarily showcase one skill to capture the interest of clients who are specifically looking for that expertise. You can always upsell your additional services to the client later.

HOW CAN WE GET PAID \$100+ HOURLY RATE ON UPWORK?

1. Visit the Talent Search Page:

<https://www.upwork.com/nx/search/talent/>

2. Filter by Category: From the left, select your job category using the Category filter.

3. Filter by Location: Choose Pakistan / your country from the Location filter for inspiration. Seeing others from your country charging high hourly rates in your category can motivate you and show that it's possible.

4. Set the Hourly Rate Filter: Change this filter to show only freelancers who are charging \$100+ per hour.

Next Steps:

1. Open Freelancer Profiles: Look at the profiles of these high-rate freelancers.

2. Verify Job Payments: Check their jobs to see if they are indeed being paid high rates by examining their in-progress and completed jobs.

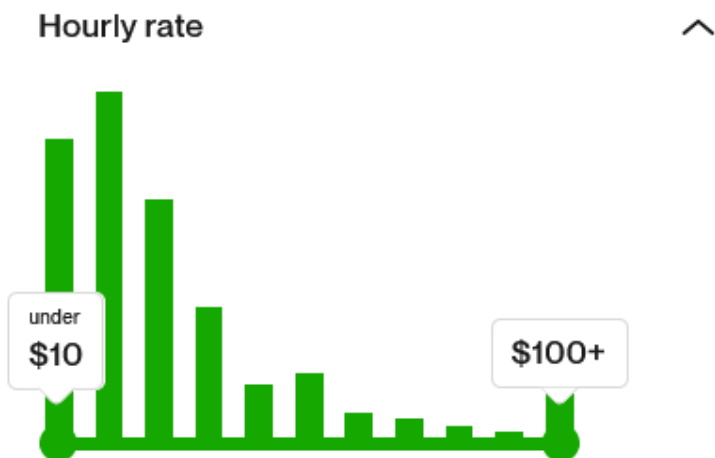
3. Check Job Details: Ensure these jobs were recent (within the last 6 months), not private, had at least 10+ proposals, and that these freelancers weren't the only ones invited to the job.

Study Their Profiles:

1. Assess Their Jobs: Look at what kind of jobs they have applied to.

2. Review Profile Structure: Observe how their profiles are structured and what services they are offering.
3. Evaluate Skills: Check the skills they have. Compare to see if you have the same skills or identify skills you might need to acquire.
4. Plan Profile Changes: Figure out how you can change your profile or services to compete with them and ask for a high pay rate in your job category.

Note: Charging a high hourly rate can also make Upwork push your profile more in the search results for those clients who pay high rates because Upwork earns more in commission. However, you need to have the skill set that justifies a higher pay rate.



WHAT HOURLY RATE SHOULD YOU SET AS A BEGINNER ON YOUR UPWORK PROFILE?

First things first: you can apply for jobs at any hourly rate, regardless of the one listed on your profile. For instance, if your profile states an hourly rate of \$20, you can still apply for a job at \$15 per hour. However, applying for a job at a rate higher than your profile rate may turn away potential clients.

Many freelancers begin with the lowest possible rate, believing it will attract more clients due to the lower cost. However, remember that low rates often attract demanding, unprofessional clients who may never be satisfied with your work. Quality clients seek quality work and might overlook you if your rates are too low, assuming you are inexperienced and lack confidence. Additionally, the lowest rates can attract scammers who prey on your desperation to secure jobs.

So, back to the question: what should be the ideal hourly rate for a beginner? It's simple. Visit the Talent Search:

<https://www.upwork.com/nx/search/talent/>, select your job category from the left, and observe the hourly rate filter. Here, you can see the range of rates that freelancers are charging. Choose the rate that most freelancers in your category start with. That's your answer.

However, don't stick to this rate indefinitely. Use the same hourly rate filter to check what the higher-paid freelancers in your category are charging, how their services differ from yours, and what skills you need to improve to command a similar rate. For more details, refer to my last post.

CAN WE USE AN AUTO-REFRESH BROWSER EXTENSION TO REFRESH THE UPWORK JOB FEED?

According to an Upwork moderator, you can. Personally, I would avoid it and use the RSS feed instead. However, if you must use it, ensure that you don't have it enabled while actively working on hourly contracts using the Upwork time tracker, just to be on the safe side. So, if you install it, make sure it is completely disabled or even uninstalled while doing hourly work with the Upwork tracker.

If you'd like to use some tools to have your browser refresh automatically for the most recent jobs to appear, feel free to use them, as long as they don't violate Upwork [Terms of Use](#).

- Valeria



I HAVE MET ALL THE CRITERIA FOR THE RISING TALENT BADGE, YET I HAVE NOT RECEIVED IT.

The Rising Talent badge is granted at the discretion of Upwork. Even if an individual meets all the criteria, there is no guarantee of receiving the badge. It is invite-only and is awarded based on a combination of factors such as your profile details and work category. If selected, Upwork will automatically add the badge to your profile, and you do not need to take any further action.

UPWORK BOOSTED PROFILE UPDATE 2024

Upwork has improved the ad-serving algorithm and incorporated reputation signals such as 'Skills Match' and 'JSS' (Job Success Score) to ensure that clients looking for your expertise receive a higher quality match.

Check out my video "**The Art of Upwork Profile Keyword Research**" to find out how you can extract the most commonly used skills from jobs in your category to include in your profile skills. Including relevant skills in your profile increases your chances of getting the "Best Match" badge when sending proposals and appearing at the top of the boosted profiles when clients are prompted to invite freelancers after submitting a job.

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=15YKMkHV2YE>

A COMMON UPWORK PROFILE ISSUE I'VE NOTICED

99.99% of the Upwork profiles I have reviewed have terrible profile pictures. Smiling doesn't cost money. Put up a smile, please. Make yourself appear pleasant. Give good vibes to the client so they visit your profile. A good profile picture makes a big difference. Who will work with a grumpy freelancer?

If your mother is telling you that you look like a prince or princess in the picture, don't believe her. She is not your client. Lol.

KEYWORD STUFFING IN YOUR UPWORK PROFILE DESCRIPTION

I am not denying that adding a multitude of keywords to your Upwork profile description can rank you for those keywords (if you are actively working on jobs or sending proposals), but at what cost?

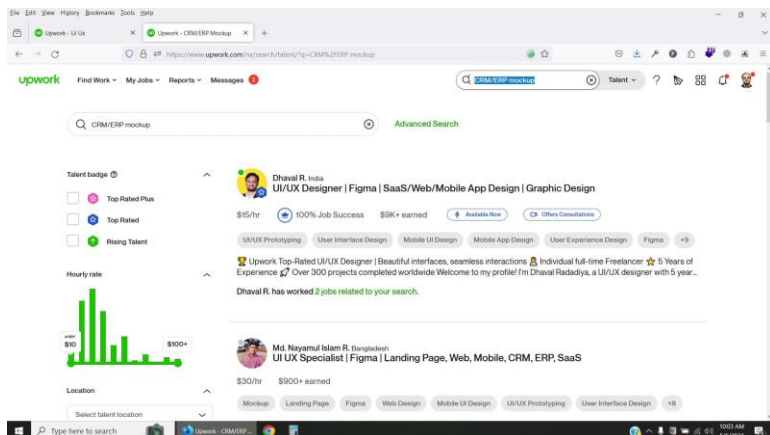
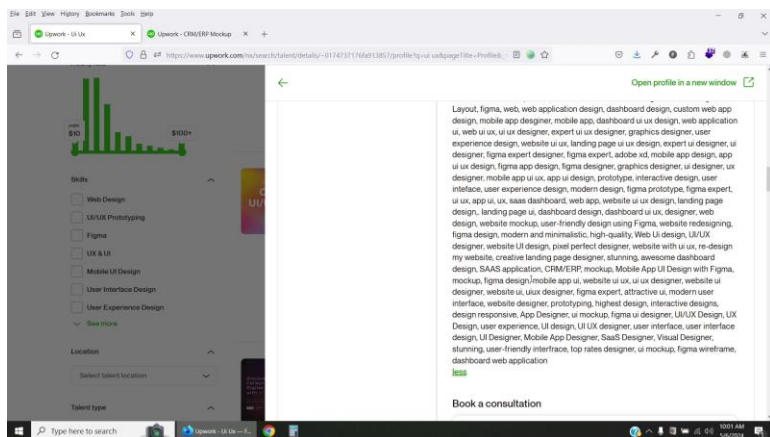
In the first picture, you can see how an individual has added so many keywords to the bottom of his profile description. Now, put yourself in a client's shoes, and let's say you are looking for a freelancer who does "CRM/ERP mockup." You search for the keyword and get the two profiles as seen in the second picture.

The first profile, which has engaged in keyword stuffing (first picture), has nowhere written "CRM/ERP" in its profile title and profile description, but the second profile has. If you were a client, what are the chances that you would click on the second profile and not the first one?

This is the exact reason why people complain about not getting profile views or invites: you are ranking for the wrong keyword. When the client sees your profile in the search results, they see your title and only the first two lines of the description. If you haven't mentioned your main keyword in those locations, the client is unlikely to take notice of your profile.

That's why I have been strongly suggesting niching down and sticking to one skill only. Because when a client is searching for that skill, and they see the exact same skill in your profile title or the first two lines of the description, then they are most likely to take interest in your profile.

If you have multiple skills, you can always upsell them after finishing a job for a client in your main skill. I started as a WordPress developer for my initial projects for my clients, but I have also worked on Magento, Shopify, Silverstripe, Webflow, Technical SEO, custom applications, etc., for the same clients later on.



I WAS INVITED BY AN UPWORK CLIENT TO A JOB THAT IS IRRELEVANT TO MY SKILLS. SHOULD I REJECT IT?

Accepting a job, if you have boosted your profile and received the invitation, does not cost Connects. In that scenario, I will accept everything that comes my way. However, if you must reject it, look at the skills the client has selected for the job and see if one or more of the skills match your profile skills. If yes, you must accept the job. Otherwise, you can reject it. Because if you reject it and one or more of the skills match your profile skills, Upwork might start degrading your profile in the search results for those skills later on, and you might lose out on invitations to some of the legitimate jobs that you can do.

But what would you say in your proposal if the work described in the job description is not something you do? Simply tell the client that you do not provide the services the client is looking for, followed by mentioning the services you actually provide. The client might hire you for your services later. You never know.

If applying to an irrelevant job costs you Connects because of the new Upwork rule, simply refer it to someone you know who might be a better fit using the "Refer A Freelancer" feature.

I JUST RECEIVED A DIRECT JOB OFFER
FROM AN UPWORK CLIENT I DON'T KNOW,
WITHOUT HAVING SENT A PROPOSAL.
SHOULD I ACCEPT IT?

If I were a new freelancer, I would reject it without a second thought. That's how most scams are carried out, targeting new and gullible freelancers. Think about it: why would someone hire you directly without knowing you first?

You might even get paid for the work, as they mostly use stolen credit cards, only for it to be charged back later. This could lead to Upwork suspecting your involvement in the fraud and suspending your account.

If they are also asking you to contact them outside of Upwork, report the job to Upwork as a precautionary measure and help cleanse the platform of these scammers.

MY BROTHER/SISTER/FAMILY MEMBER ALSO WANTS TO WORK ON UPWORK, BUT WE HAVE ONLY ONE LAPTOP AT HOME.

Sharing your computer with another user is allowed by Upwork. There are no issues. However, I always recommend that everyone emails Upwork and informs them beforehand that you will be sharing your computer with another Upwork user, and ask whether it will cause any issues. When you receive their response confirming that there won't be any issues, take a screenshot of their response and save it somewhere, just in case they raise any issues later.

You should also do the above if you are using your Upwork account in multiple locations (e.g., home and office). I know of 2-3 incidents where Upwork suspended accounts on the grounds that multiple people were using them. They did unsuspend the accounts later, but it is always safer to inform them beforehand and get a response from them, just to be on the safe side.

WILL GOING PAST THE DUE DATE ON A MILESTONE OF MY UPWORK FIXED-PRICE CONTRACT AFFECT MY JSS?

The "due date" associated with a fixed-price contract or milestone is simply a text string displayed to users for reference purposes. Upwork DOES NOT USE IT. Upwork systems will NOT penalize you in any way for missing a due date. If a client is fine with it, then you don't have any problem. The only things that affect your JSS are the client's private and public feedback and having long-term jobs.

Add milestone

×

Name of milestone 9

Amount

Due date (Optional)

 2024-05-31 ▼

All dates and times are based on UTC

Description (Optional)

Cancel

Save & add another

Save

HOW DO YOU FIGURE OUT IF A CLIENT IS LEGIT BEFORE ACCEPTING A JOB ON UPWORK?

In one of my previous posts, I suggested not accepting any direct offers from anyone if you are a new freelancer. Someone read that post and saved himself from a scam by refunding all the money. Upwork also closed that job later. When you are a new freelancer and get scammed by accepting a direct offer, Upwork could also suspect you of being involved in credit card fraud and suspend your account too.

But what if you are an established freelancer and get invited to a job by a new client or receive a direct offer from a new client? What should you do in that case?

I came across two situations recently. One freelancer wasn't sure whether to accept an offer he received from an interview with a new client. He sent me a screenshot with the client's name and the country listed on the job post. I Googled "client name country" and found a person with the same name and country on LinkedIn. I also found his website. Upon observing both, I confirmed he was in the same industry that he wanted the project done in, so the client turned out to be legit. P.S. I also used to do the same when I was new to Upwork (previously oDesk).

The second scenario was interesting: It was a direct job offer. The freelancer had already done his due diligence and found the client on LinkedIn. The client had a lot of followers and was a CEO of a firm. The freelancer showed me the website the client wanted to redesign. I checked the website and

found the client's name on the about page. I also found the same website/company on his LinkedIn page. So it looked like a legit client to me, but the freelancer had some doubts because of his past bad experiences and how the client sent an offer of \$5 for a huge project (it turned out he was a new client and didn't have much knowledge of Upwork and was also not a native English speaker). So he messaged the client on LinkedIn to confirm, which seemed like a great option at that time, but I wouldn't suggest doing it. However, the client responded on LinkedIn, confirming it was him, and that also turned out to be a legit client.

How do you do your due diligence? Please share so everyone can benefit from it.

GETTING INTERVIEWS ON UPWORK BUT THE CLIENT ENDS UP HIRING SOMEONE ELSE?

You've been getting your proposals viewed and even getting responses from clients. But after a little conversation, the client ghosts you. Later, you check the job and see that the client has hired someone else. That must be heartbreaking.

So, what went wrong? After observing the communication of many freelancers, I came across three reasons that could potentially put off clients, resulting in them hiring someone else.

Reason 1: Poor Communication/Lazy Answers

Good communication is the key to closing clients. Take this scenario:

Client: Hey, have you worked on Gravity Forms?

Freelancer 1: yes

Freelancer 2: I can do

Freelancer 3: Hey. Yes, I can work on Gravity Forms. I have created everything from simple contact forms to complex forms with conditional fields. I can also customize the form functionality using custom code. I have integrated many payment methods with the form as well.

Who do you think the client will be attracted to?

Short or one-word answers can make the client think you're not serious about the work or even find you disrespectful. So,

take some time and put some effort into your answers. The more detailed, the better!

Reason 2: Project Cost

When clients ask you what you will charge for the work, most freelancers just provide a number without explaining what the work will involve. Take this example:

Client: How much will this website cost?

Freelancer 1: \$1000

Freelancer 2: Hey. The website will cost \$1000. Here is the cost breakdown:

Milestone 1: [Details of milestone 1] - \$300

Milestone 2: [Details of milestone 2] - \$200

Milestone 3: [Details of milestone 3] - \$100

Milestone 4: [Details of milestone 4] - \$200

Milestone 5: [Details of milestone 5] - \$200

Most clients don't know the technicalities involved in the work. Just providing the cost might make some clients think you are overcharging them. However, the clearer the picture you provide, the more clients will understand the steps involved in the work. They will appreciate your transparency and will be more inclined to work with you.

Reason 3: You Ask Too Many Questions

Asking questions to gain clarity on the scope of work is very important. You should always ask questions and fully

understand the project before accepting the work. But how many questions should you ask the client?

Answer: Treat clients as if they are babies.

When I talk to a potential client, I assume they might not know much about what they want done in their project, and it's my responsibility to educate them.

So, when I ask questions, I also give suggestions and try to provide a clear picture of how their project could look.

Example below:

Client: I want a website to sell flowers.

Freelancer 1: What will be the platform? What will be the payment gateway? What will be the shipping method?

Freelancer 2: Hey. Do you have any reference websites that I can look at? I found this website that sells flowers: [websitename]. Are you looking for something like this? How are you expecting to receive payments from customers? Would they be paying by credit card or is cash on delivery also an option?

I also won't bombard them with too many questions in a single message. I will keep a few questions in each message and slowly guide them from the first step to the last step (I am treating them as babies, remember?) so, in the end, nothing remains vague, and they know exactly what they are looking for. Check my email communication case study: <https://farazthewebguy.com/email-communication-case-study.pdf>

If you are like Freelancer 1 above and ask too many questions without giving any input of your own, and the

client is non-technical, it will just confuse and frustrate them.
Guess who they will go with?

UPWORK FREE CONNECTS UPDATE 2024

Upwork no longer gives 50 free connects to new users upon sign-up. However, you will still receive 10 free connects each month. To obtain the 50 free connects, you will need to either purchase 100 Connects or subscribe to the Freelancer Plus plan. Once you choose one of these options, you will receive a one-time bonus of 50 Connects.

Here is my take on this:

There are too many freelancers on the platform, and Upwork wants to get rid of most of them. You need to understand this from the business point of view. Without clients and projects, Upwork won't have any business. When clients post jobs, they get a lot of crap proposals, and they often don't hire and try other platforms. That's one of the reasons you don't see hirings on all the jobs. I have been a client, and I have faced this issue. One time, I had to pay Upwork to find me a suitable freelancer because I didn't get good proposals.

By implementing these new policies, they want to make sure that people stop creating multiple fake accounts and send proposals using free connects. Because when one account gets a job, people verify that account and delete the rest.

Whatever policies you disagree with, they are also a business and here to make money, and people are paying them in the form of connects. Why would they change anything? They are not going to worry about most freelancers leaving. They want to become the next Toptal.

UPWORK'S NEW FEEDBACK POLICY: WHAT TOP RATED FREELANCERS NEED TO KNOW

Upwork is changing how feedback is managed on the platform. Starting September 3, 2024, Top Rated and Top Rated Plus freelancers will no longer have the option to remove feedback.

Though I have never used this feature and know it can be manipulated by people, every Top Rated freelancer will now have to be very careful when applying to jobs. This means you might start seeing fewer proposals on jobs.

First, they took away the 5% commission feature from Top Rated Plus, and now this. They also changed their search interface months ago, and now Top Rated freelancers don't get the apparent advantage because instead of showing the Top Rated label next to the freelancers, they now show a small icon, which I missed for weeks. So, a 100% JSS is more important, despite your badge. They do show the Top Rated label when you are sending proposals, though.

PEOPLE WHO ARE STRUGGLING TO WIN THEIR FIRST JOB ON UPWORK

If you think you have tried everything and still are not able to find success on Upwork, try my strategy, which many people resist following, and that's where you can take advantage by going against the tide. That's what I did when I started out. That's what hundreds of people following me did and became successful. It could take some time, so you will need patience (important for a freelancer), but you might hit a sixer on your first ball, too, like I and many others did:

Apply to clients posting their first job with no payment history and no job history.

Reluctant because they might turn out to be scammers? Most people also think like you and will avoid such clients, which means there will be less competition for those jobs, as most freelancers try to avoid them.

What does that mean? It means that these clients will have a small pool to hire from (mostly new freelancers), and if a client is legit and actually looking to hire and you write a good proposal (check my free Upwork resources for writing good proposals), you have a great chance to land your first client.

Most new clients don't notice the Job Success Score (JSS). They focus on the profile picture and the proposal. Even if they do notice the JSS or educate themselves about Upwork before hiring someone, most skilled freelancers don't apply for these jobs, leaving clients mostly with completely new (0 JSS) or low JSS freelancers. So, guess who they end up choosing? This approach has been tried and tested; many

people have also improved their poor JSS from the 70s and 80s to 100 by targeting these clients.

However, the main reason I emphasize new clients is that there is a high chance of them working with you again and becoming a long-term client if their first experience on the platform with you turns out to be exceptional. Why would they go through the trouble of posting a job again and hiring someone else in your niche when they have already found you? Highly unlikely. So, under-promise and over-deliver, and get out of that bidding rate race.

But how do you save yourself from scams? Check my Upwork guide. Everything I know and have ever posted about Upwork is in the guide. Take your time and go through it, and you will find answers to all your questions instead of coming to me for everything. I can bet on that.

Remember, every established client was a new client at one point. You don't need to avoid them. When I posted a job as a new client and invited top freelancers to apply, they rejected my invites because I was a new client. So I ended up hiring from a pool of freelancers who applied to my job, and they have been working with me for the last 2.5 years. 😊

UPWORK'S LATEST CHANGE JUNE 6TH, 2024: CONNECTS NOW REQUIRED FOR JOB INVITES

Beginning June 6, 2024, when clients invite you to apply for a job on Upwork, you'll now need to use Connects to submit a proposal. This change means that regardless of how freelancers find a job, Connects will be required to apply.

As a result, more freelancers might decline invites, and clients will need to consider those who paid to apply. It could also stop scammers from inviting new freelancers since they won't have free Connects to start with.

I can see both pros and cons to this change.

Although it hasn't been officially announced, I noticed the update in their help article:

<https://support.upwork.com/hc/en-us/articles/211062998-Submit-a-Proposal>

CAN WE OUTSOURCE PROJECTS ON UPWORK AS FREELANCERS?

Yes, you can, but note that on Upwork, outsourcing work is permitted only under a Fixed-Price contract. What's important is that no one shares access to your tracker app on hourly contracts with other people.

NEW CHANGES TO UPWORK'S PROPOSAL SUBMISSIONS

I mentioned this weeks ago when I first noticed it, but they officially announced it on June 3rd.

What has changed? The number of Connects needed to apply for a job will now vary based on the type of project and other factors. It's related to how much the client is willing to pay. High-paying jobs will cost more Connects. Longer projects will also cost more Connects. If a job has a lot of proposals, it will cost more Connects.

How can you find jobs with a lower number of Connects? Use my tool while it still works because you never know when Upwork will change their programming:

<https://farazthewebguy.com/upwork-job-search-link-generator/>

Password: super@347

I WEAR A VEIL. CAN I UPLOAD MY PROFILE PICTURE WITH IT? WOULD UPWORK VERIFY MY PROFILE?

Yes, you can. Here is the direct response from Upwork:

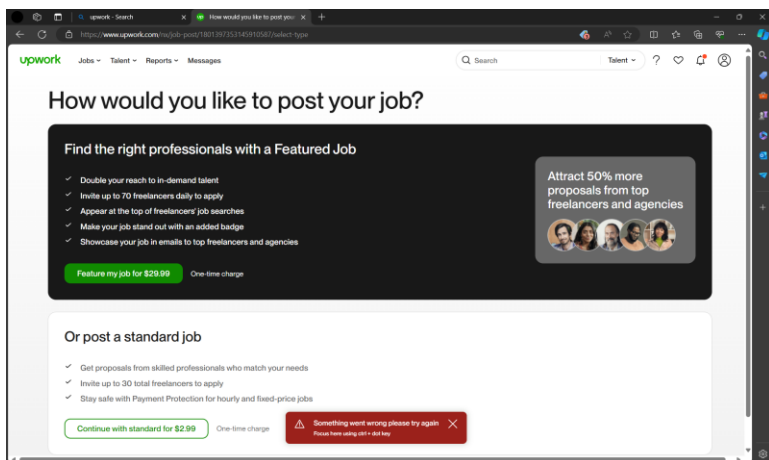
If you would like to request a religious exemption for using a profile picture, please follow these steps:

1. Visit Contact Support and click the 'Chat with Upwork' button.
2. Type a question or topic and select 'Send'. The bot will find relevant Help articles for you.
3. The chatbot will ask you to confirm if you need additional help. If you confirm that you need additional help, you will be asked to confirm the account type you need help with.
4. From there, the support options available to you will be listed. Select either of the options to be able to contact the Upwork Support Team.

UPWORK IMPLEMENTS NEW JOB POSTING FEES FOR CLIENTS

Upwork is making changes to how clients post jobs, and now they are asking clients to pay for job postings.

<https://support.upwork.com/hc/en-us/articles/30025820464659-Fees-to-post-a-job>



After you fill out the details of your job post, you'll pay a fee to make it live. This fee helps us attract top talent and invest in features for clients like you.

Types of job posts and fees

Standard Job Post Fee: For a fee of up to \$9.99 USD, you can post a job and find a skilled professional to help. You'll be able to view proposals from interested freelancers and interview candidates before moving forward with a contract. [Learn more about posting a job.](#)

Featured Job Post Fee: For a one-time fee of \$29.99 USD, you can feature your job post to help reach more freelancers and agencies in less time and attract top talent. [Learn more about Featured Jobs.](#)

WITH UPWORK NOW REQUIRING CONNECTS FOR INVITATIONS, IS PROFILE OPTIMIZATION STILL WORTHWHILE?

Yes, it's still beneficial to optimize your profile. You can still get work without applying to jobs using Connects if:

1. The client hires you directly from your profile by clicking the hire button.
2. You have already used Connects to boost your profile, and the client sends you an invitation when they post a job.
3. You are part of an Upwork Talent Group. See screenshot below.
4. There are some jobs where you won't need to use Connects when invited. It's not mentioned what type of jobs these are, but they are most likely posted by new verified clients or if you are invited by an Upwork Talent Specialist to apply to a job.

Personally, I never really stressed about profile optimization. My formula on Upwork has been very simple since day one: Want work? Search for a project and apply to it. I like being proactive and having things under my control instead of waiting on outside factors (invitations, project catalog) to get work. Hence, I never really cared about my own profile. If your proposals are good and prove your worth to the client, they are not going to care about what you say in your profile description.



Filters and notifications to prioritize job posts in the network



The ability to submit proposals to jobs in the network without spending any Connects

[Browse Talent Cloud](#)

Thanks,
The Upwork Team

CAN WE USE A VPN WHILE WORKING WITH THE UPWORK TIME TRACKER?

Using a VPN is not a violation of Upwork's TOS. However, be advised that if there are inconsistencies with your IP address, your account may be flagged to prevent unauthorized access to your account.

After flagged (if flagged. It is not necessary) you will be suspended for verification. Proceed verification as asked. You won't be banned if your account is legal.

VPN usage within work requirements is allowed.

It's better to use a VPN browser extension, and then you can use the extension inside the browser to change your IP address. No need to mess with the system network settings.

SHOULD WE BID ON LOW-BUDGET JOBS/TASKS NOW THAT CONNECTS ARE MORE EXPENSIVE?

If you are new and it's a job you can do 100%, I highly recommend you take it. Don't think short-term or calculate your profits on each job when you are new. Complete those small jobs to build up your profile. If it's a new client posting their first job, they might become your long-term client too.

All my 5- and 6-figure long-term clients initially started with a single-figure job.

WHEN SENDING A PROPOSAL ON UPWORK, CAN I INCLUDE A LINK TO MY EXTERNAL PORTFOLIO AND/OR ATTACH A RESUME?

You can share links to external portfolios and/or attach a resume when you submit a proposal. Just make sure no contact information is present (see screenshot below). In simple terms, you should be fine as long as the external link does not display any of your direct contact information and the site doesn't require clients to provide any contact information, such as an email address, to access your past works.

12:02

✈️ 📶 48



Thank you for your response. Please allow me to further assist you.

To clarify, the notification only serves as a reminder of Upwork's Terms of Service, specifically that it prohibits sharing contact information or ways to get in touch directly before a contract starts.

We do understand that sharing of past work is important to show your potential to complete a future project. Therefore, we recommend you to share screenshots of your past work showcasing your skills. Please note that Requesting, Providing, sharing of social media accounts, handles, or IDs is not allowed before a contract is started. You can also provide screenshots or walk through the account via screen share during an interview to scope the project.

Also please be informed that as long as the portfolio/web page has no any direct contact information, no request for any contact information and/or any means to connect with you directly, you are allowed to share it.

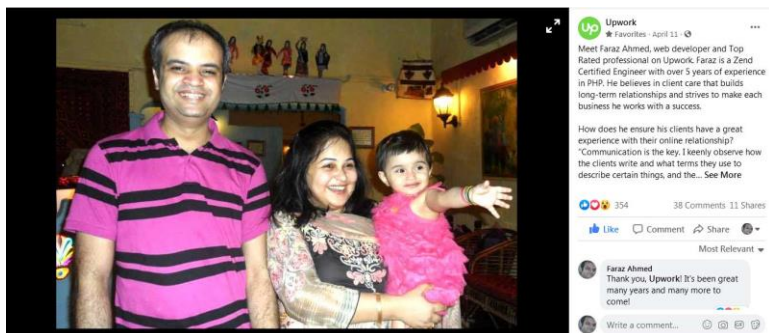
Same with showcasing your past works, as long as long it does not include any contact information and no means to connect with you directly, you are also allowed to share

ABOUT THE AUTHOR



Faraz Ahmed is a Zend Certified PHP Developer and CBT Life Coach from Karachi, Pakistan, and the Top Rated+ Freelancer on Upwork. He has been using Upwork to find freelancing opportunities for almost ten years now. With over 14,000 hours of work completed, he's a pro when it comes to writing excellent freelance proposals.

He has also been mentioned by Upwork on their social media pages and website a few times.



ONE LAST THING...

I hope that you find the tips in this guide helpful for your freelancing career. Don't forget to follow me on Facebook for more tips:

<https://www.facebook.com/faraz.ahmed84/>

Upwork Free Video Course (Urdu/Hindi):

<https://www.youtube.com/playlist?list=PLSVSIhot0UKFWgXTxNaLWCOqZcHegIFg->

Check out my website for my AI Proposal Writer:

<https://farazthewebguy.com/>

Thank you for reading!